UTRGV Football Coaching Tree History

EDGE3 · UTRGV Recruiting Intelligence Pilot · prepared for Dennis Livshyts · October 22, 2026

Why this exists

The UTRGV pilot reads every recruit against the coach's own standard, not a national average. The position archetypes come from two inputs: what the staff tells Cam in the Positional Baseline Workbook, and what each coach's history says about the players who produced for him and the players who did not. This document is the second input: the coaching tree for Head Coach Travis Bush and every position coach on the 2026 staff, with the top-performing and low-performing players at each stop where a tree could be mapped.

Coach Bush is a first-time college head coach, so his tree goes back to every stop where he was an assistant (Texas State, UTSA, Houston, Buffalo Bills) and his two Texas high school head-coaching jobs. The same method is applied to the ten position coaches.

Dennis's October 9 summary referenced "the tree designed for Coach Bush" as the template for coaching-tree data in the model. That earlier artifact could not be located in the Edge3-demos repo, Google Drive, Gmail, or the cloud sessions searchable from this environment, so this is a fresh run. If the original turns up on the desktop, treat this document as the superset and reconcile the two.

Method and limits

- Sources: official school bios, conference all-conference releases, NFL and UFL team releases, Wikipedia season pages, and regional press (Texas Football, RGV Sports, KRGV, Tucson.com and others). Every timeline row and every player row carries its source URLs.
- Rule for LOW performers: a player is listed as LOW only when a source documents the outcome (benched, transferred out after a down year, "expected breakout" that did not happen). No player is called low on judgment alone. That rule keeps the LOW set small and honest. It is thin on purpose.
- Direct page fetches failed from this environment (goutrgv.com, school sites and Wikipedia did not resolve), so every fact comes from search-result excerpts of the cited pages. Anything marked "unverified" or "not found" should be confirmed on the page before it is used in a coach-facing surface.
- FCS, Division II, JUCO and high school stops have little public honors coverage. Where a stop says "thin," the gap is in the public record, not in the coach.

Ranking rule for the player lists

Within each stop, the TOP and LOW lists are sorted highest to lowest by the same key: NFL outcome first, production second, PFF grade third.

Column	Values
NFL	NFL (drafted, NFL roster, or NFL honors) ranks above Pro (undrafted free agent, camp, practice squad, Arena/CFL/UFL), which ranks above blank. The Bills 2015 room is NFL by definition.
Production	6 All-American or conference/national player of the year · 5 first-team all-conference · 4 second team, newcomer, freshman or rookie of the year · 3 honorable mention, third team, all-region or academic · 2 school record or team-leading production · 1 stats only
PFF best	Best PFF season grade during the coach's years at that stop, matched on player, team and position group, from the licensed PFF NCAA tables in edge3-model (FBS, 2014 to 2025). Blank at FCS, D2, JUCO, high school and pre-2014 stops is expected. 26 of 103 player rows carry a PFF grade.

The three levels are stored on every player row in `coaching_tree.json` and `coaching_tree_players.csv` (`nfl_level`, `honor_level`, `pff_best`), so the sort can be re-run or changed in code.

The 2026 staff and where each tree roots

Coach	2026 title	Tree roots	Years as position coach or coordinator	Timeline confidence	Player-list confidence
Travis Bush	Head Coach	Texas State (Bailiff, Wright), UTSA (Coker), Houston (Levine, Meacham), Bills (Ryan, Roman, Lynn)	2004 to present	Medium-High	Medium

Coach	2026 title	Tree roots	Years as position coach or coordinator	Timeline confidence	Player-list confidence
Brian Gamble	Asst. HC, Defensive Coordinator, LB	Texas A&M (Slocum, as player), Incarnate Word (Santiago, Kennan), Louisiana Tech (Holtz), Texas State (Spavitals)	2004 to present	Medium	Low-Medium
Jeff Bowen	Co-OC, Offensive Line	Texas State (played for Bush-era staff), UTSA (Coker, Bush), Northwestern State, NEO A&M, SFA, Northeastern State	2014 to present	Medium	Low
Theron Aych	Co-OC, Quarterbacks (play-caller)	Angelo State (Wagner), UTEP (Kugler), Arizona (Rodriguez, Sumlin), Tennessee State (George), Oklahoma State (Gundy, Meacham)	1997 to present	Medium	Low-Medium
Adrian McDonald	Pass Game Coordinator, Safeties	Houston (played under Levine while Bush was OC; Zac Spavital his DB coach), Texas State (Spavitals), Midwestern State	2018 to present	High	Low
Gunnar Henderson	Pass Game Coordinator, Wide Receivers	UTRGV only (Bush); played at UIW (Morris) and TCU (Patterson, Dykes)	2024 to present	High	Medium-Low
Mike Barela	Run Game Coordinator, Tight Ends	Texas State (Wright, with Bush), Northeastern State (Evans), UIW (Kennan), Colorado Mesa and Valdosta State (Jackson)	1996 to present	Medium-High	Medium
Marco Regalado	Running Backs, Recruiting Coordinator	Rice personnel (Bloomgren), Washington State recruiting, Jaguars fellowship; one HS RB season before UTRGV	2020 to present (on-field)	Medium	Low-Medium
James Lockhart IV	Outside Linebackers	Baylor and Texas Tech (Joey McGuire, C.J. Ah You, DeRuyter)	2024 to present	High	Low
Nate Langford	Defensive Line	Texas State (played under Bush-era staff), Seguin HS (Bush's DC), Luling HS (HC)	2016 to present	Medium	Low
Josh Jones	Special Teams Coordinator, Cornerbacks	Henderson State (Maxfield), Central Arkansas and South Alabama (Campbell, Stewart), Brahmas (Wade Phillips)	2015 to present	High	Medium (UCA, South Alabama), Low elsewhere

How the staff connects: shared nodes in the tree

The staff is not eleven separate trees. It is one tree with a few trunks, and that matters for the archetype: the same offensive lineage is being applied by several coaches at once.

1. **Texas State, 2004 to 2010 (the trunk).** Bush coached WRs then was associate head coach and co-OC under Brad Wright. Bowen played center on that offense (2008 first-team All-Southland). Langford played DE for the same program while Bush was on staff. Barela coached tight ends and ran operations next to Bush from 2007 to 2010. Regalado is a Texas State graduate. Five of eleven staff members share this root.
2. **UTSA, 2011 (the start-up).** Bush was the first offensive coordinator; Bowen was an offensive GA on the same inaugural staff. Bush has said publicly that UTSA's start-from-scratch build is the blueprint for UTRGV.
3. **Houston, 2012 to 2014.** Bush was running backs coach, then play-caller and assistant head coach under Tony Levine. McDonald was the starting safety on those teams and set the school interception record. Doug Meacham was Bush's co-OC in 2013 and was Aych's offensive coordinator at Oklahoma State in 2025, which is the one scheme bridge between Bush and his new play-caller.
4. **Seguin High School, 2016 to 2020.** Bush was head coach, Langford was his defensive coordinator, and UTRGV's best 2025 pass rusher, Ian Box, is a Seguin product.
5. **The Spavital node.** Zac Spavital coached McDonald at Houston and brought him to Texas State as a GA; Gamble coached inside linebackers on the same Texas State staff in 2021 and 2022. Gamble's 2022 unit was credited with the best defensive production in Texas State's FBS history.
6. **Incarnate Word.** Gamble spent ten years there (DL coach, then defensive coordinator); Barela coached tight ends and the run game there in 2015 to 2017; Henderson played there in 2018 and 2019.

Outliers with their own trees: Aych (South Dakota, JUCO, Angelo State, Arizona, Tennessee State, Oklahoma State), Lockhart (Baylor and Texas Tech, Joey McGuire), Jones (Arkansas and Alabama FCS/G5 circuit, then the UFL).

Cross-staff archetype summary

Each line is built only from the documented players in the dossiers that follow. Read it as a prior for the position baseline, not as a label on any recruit.

Position group	Coach	What the top performers had in common	Where the pattern broke (documented LOW)
Offense, program-wide	Bush	Volume pass-game producers: record-setting WRs (Luke 17 TD, Greenberry 100 ypg), accurate and moderately mobile QBs (George 63%, Marburger 31 TD, Ward as a converted athlete). Mostly Texas HS products or Texas-college transfers; honors came as often from lightly recruited players as from blue-chips.	Both documented lows are pocket QBs in year two of a system who lost the job to a more mobile replacement (Piland 2012, O'Korn 2014). Projection risk is highest at drop-back QB after a staff or scheme change.
Quarterback	Aych	Oversized or athletically unusual converts and dual-threat producers (Washington 3,691 pass and 831 rush yds; Walker WR-to-NFL TE; Poindexter 6-5 late bloomer). Low-pedigree origins: D2, JUCO, walk-on. Production spikes in year two or three, not year one.	Lows cluster around staff churn (Arizona 2020, Tennessee State 2022) rather than misreads; Curry is the one "expected breakout" that did not produce.
Wide receiver	Henderson	One season of data. Both top producers were young (Diaz a true freshman), high-TD, and left for FBS within a year. The room exports talent.	None documented. The retention problem is upward, not downward.
Offensive line	Bowen	Young and developmental (Hughes all-conference as a true freshman), a JUCO-to-FBS track record (four of five NEO sophomores signed FBS), durability and availability (Wrather 24 straight starts). Pass protection is the measured output.	None documented.
Tight end and run game	Barela	Power-5 drop-down transfers and position converts (Bowie, Smith Flores). Blocking-first TEs with red-zone value (Smith Flores 20 catches, 6 TD). Honors land on the OL when he coaches OL.	None documented; only upward departure (Smith Flores to ECU).

Position group	Coach	What the top performers had in common	Where the pattern broke (documented LOW)
Running back	Regalado	One season of data. Lead back was a mature graduate transfer (Denney, Yale) in a committee inside a pass-first offense; stated philosophy is downhill. Sourcing leans on the portal (Denney, Lane from LSU for 2026).	None documented.
Defense, program-wide and LB	Gamble	High-volume tacklers over rated recruits (Grubbs 99, Baldwin 85, Haygood 102). Overlooked origins: walk-on, FBS transfer down, true freshman at a start-up. Plays young ILBs early. Multiple and 3-4 fronts ask ILBs to stack tackles.	The one documented low (Foster) was a productive starter who transferred up to Louisville. The failure mode is retention of producers, not evaluation.
Outside linebacker and edge	Lockhart	Long 235 to 265 lb edge rushers used as stand-up/hand-down hybrids (Box; Wilson by association at Texas Tech). Texas HS products arriving as bounce-back transfers rather than rated recruits.	None documented (one season).
Defensive line	Langford	Texas-rooted, non-blue-chip paths: FCS transfer (Box), developmental redshirt producing as a rotational sub (Anderson), veteran grad-transfer nose (Huerta). Every HS stop carries a “most improved defense” tag.	None documented (one season).
Safeties	McDonald	Ball-production players who mirror McDonald’s own 17-INT profile (Prosser pick-six, Graham All-American buzz). First-year players on the field (Davis, Prosser). Nickel/“star” versatility.	None documented.
Cornerbacks and special teams	Jones	Takeaway and pass-breakup volume over size (Smith 10 INT/37 PD, Thompson 9 INT, Williams nation-leading PBU claim). JUCO and small-school Southern origins. All documented production came in a Campbell/Stewart 4-3 at FCS/G5 level.	None documented.

Two staff-wide signals stand out. First, almost every documented top performer was lightly recruited, a transfer down, a walk-on, or a true freshman; blue-chip high school recruits are rare in every tree. Second, where lows exist at all, they are either pocket QBs after a scheme change or productive players who transferred up. The staff’s historical risk is losing its best players to FBS, not misjudging them.

How to use this in the pilot

- `coaching_tree.json` holds the full structure: for each coach, the timeline (years, school, role, who they worked under, sources), mentors, archetype bullets, confidence, gaps, and each stop with TOP and LOW player rows. `coaching_tree_players.csv` and `coaching_tree_timeline.csv` are the flattened versions.
- The archetype bullets are priors for the position baseline that Cam collects in the workbook. When the coach names his own two players per position, those names outrank this document. Where the coach’s names and this history agree, the archetype is strong; where they disagree, flag it for the coach rather than averaging.
- Do not train on the LOW set. It is too small and too dependent on staff churn to carry signal. Use it as a list of documented failure modes to check a recruit against (pocket QB in a new system, producer likely to be poached upward).
- Mentor names and schemes are the join keys to the model’s existing coaching data (CFBD covers FBS head coaches only). Assistant and FCS histories in this document are the part CFBD does not have.

Chase Ames: what was pulled, and what Coach Bush received

Chase Ames is a 2027 quarterback from Dripping Springs High School (Texas Class 6A). He is the recruit whose read was built on Coach Bush's own history rather than UTRGV's one-season program history, and that method is now Rule 1 below. The record, from Gmail, Drive and the edge3-model repo:

Date	What	Where it lives
June 12, 2026	Ames family check-in (Chase, Matt Ames, Brian, Kenyon). The decision was a pivot to targeting specific coaching systems and downstream schools with a clear path to playing time, instead of star-based rankings.	Drive: "Ames Family Edge3 Check in, 2026/06/12, Notes by Gemini"
July 13, 2026	Brian sent Chase and Matt a personalized UTRGV visit guide for the July 14 visit, with the questions to ask on the visit.	Email "UTRGV/ Chase Ames"; page amesutrgv.netlify.app
July 13, 2026	Brian sent Coach Bush the UTRGV Risk/Fit wallet on Chase "and how he maps to your program," plus the model and pilot breakdown. NIL material was held back for the staff meeting.	Email "Chase Ames/ Edge3 Pilot" to travis.bush@utrgv.edu; page utrgvamesriskfit.netlify.app
July 15, 2026	The staff demo built for UTRGV carried the Chase file: one year as a varsity starter in Texas 6A, 3,736 yards, 48 TD, 71 percent completions, 12-2; rhythm passer for a proven passing offense; low flight risk (in-state, 4.0 anchor, recruited-to-play fit); comp anchor "the Marburger arc," with Zappe and Mestemaker as the overlooked Texas passers who walked the same road. The file was labeled a comp-anchored EDGE3 staff evaluation. Sources pulled for it: Hudl film, MaxPreps, On3, PFF.	Session "Build Edge3 interactive demo for UTRGV coaching staff"; Desktop `edge3-utrgv-demo/index.html`
August 1 to 2, 2026	Official offer letter from Cameron Herrera; Chase forwarded "It's official!"	Email "Official Offer Letter - 27 QB Chase Ames"
October 21, 2026	Brian asked Cam about a revenue-share agreement for Chase's commitment. Cam: Coach Bush handles revenue share; UTRGV has not paid a high school recruit revenue share and has not raised it.	Email "Chase Ames"
In edge3-model	The pattern was generalized: `scripts/build_utrgv_fcs_comps.py` ("UTRGV FCS comp mapping, Chase Ames pattern, generalized") builds comps for every UTRGV player from rooms Coach Bush knows personally first (Texas State, UTSA, Houston), then regional G5, then the full cohort. The Garret Rangel comp card follows the same anchor ("your offense just made a Walter Payton Award finalist out of this room"). `docs/athletes/wallets/chase-ames/` is the public sample preview, structure only.	edge3-model repo

Two things could not be retrieved from this environment: the two Netlify pages themselves (the domain does not resolve here, and their source is not in either repo, so they were deployed from the desktop), and the FBS/FCS media-guide mapping run. The only media-guide references in edge3-model are the FB-01b verification notes and the April 21 Positional Baselines scope, which proposed a one-time manual scrape of team media guides to fill OC and DC by year. `data/fcs/fcs_head_coaches_manual.csv` holds one row (Bush). The media-guide run is on the desktop or downloads, which this session cannot reach.

Rules added

Three rules now sit in `RULES.md` beside this report and in the Edge3-demos `CLAUDE.md`, with a paste block for the edge3-model `CLAUDE.md` in `EDGE3_MODEL_CLAUDE_MD_ADDITION.md`:

1. Coach history, not program history. Baselines come from the coach's own career at every stop; a first-time head coach is read through his assistant stops; media guides are the source for OC, DC and position-coach assignments by year.

2. Map every position coach to the players he coached, ranked by NFL outcome, then production, then PFF grade, highest to lowest. LOW only when documented. Never train on LOW.
3. Every row carries its source; unverified stays labeled.

Gaps and the next pass

- Full all-conference lists for Incarnate Word 2010 to 2017, Texas State 2004 to 2007 and 2021, Northwestern State, Angelo State, Tennessee State, Midwestern State 2022, and the official 2025 All-Southland roster beyond the names confirmed here.
- Recruiting ratings, sizes and hometowns for most listed players. These are the fields the archetype needs most and the public record covers least.
- Three employment holes: Aych 2008 to 2010, Regalado 2017 to 2019, Barela's 2014 Kansas high school.
- Bush's San Marcos HS assistant year could not be found in any source.
- 2026 in-season production under the new titles (Aych as play-caller, Henderson as pass game coordinator, Barela as run game coordinator, Jones on special teams) is not yet in the record.
- PFF grades for the UTRGV 2025 rows (the FCS pulls in Drive) and for the FCS stops generally; only the FBS tables were joined here.
- The FBS/FCS media-guide mapping run and the two Chase Ames Netlify pages, both on the desktop.

The per-coach dossiers follow. Each ends with its own confidence rating and gap list.

Travis Bush — Head Coach, UTRGV

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
1991–95 (grad 1995)	Gregory-Portland HS (Portland, TX)	Player, QB; UIL 4A All-State	n/a	https://goutsa.com/staff/travis-bush ; https://www.kristv.com/sports/utrgv-tabs-gregory-portland-grad-travis-bush-as-first-ever-football-coach
1995–99 (Wikipedia says 1995–2000)	Texas State (then SW Texas State)	Player, WR; 4 letters; ST captain 1999; J.C. Kellam Award 1999	n/a	https://goutsa.com/staff/travis-bush ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Travis_Bush
c. 2000	San Marcos HS	Assistant (per UTRGV bio summary)	—	not found
2001–03 (UTRGV directory says 2001–04)	TCU	Graduate assistant, offensive line (UTRGV bio: "assistant OL coach"); M.Ed. 2003; Frogs 27-10, 3 bowls, C-USA + Liberty Bowl titles	HC Gary Patterson (HC 2000–21). OC not verified	https://goutsa.com/staff/travis-bush ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/travis-bush/722 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gary_Patterson
2004–06	Texas State	Wide receivers coach ("WR coach the past three seasons" per 2007 SLC preview)	HC David Bailiff; co-OCs Blake Miller & Frank Hernandez	https://www.southland.org/news/2007/8/16/21375.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2004_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2006_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team
2007–09 (UTRGV directory: 2004–2010 "Assoc. HC / co-OC / QB / WR"; Wikipedia: 2007–2010 co-OC)	Texas State	Associate head coach + co-offensive coordinator (QBs/WRs)	HC Brad Wright (HC 2007–Nov 2010); co-OC Ben Norton	https://www.southland.org/news/2007/8/16/21375.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2007_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team ; https://goutsa.com/news/2010/01/20/utsa-hires-travis-bush-as-offensive-coordinator
Jan 2010–Jan 2012 (one playing season, 2011)	UTSA	Offensive coordinator / QBs, inaugural staff; 2011: 4-6, independent, spread offense	HC Larry Coker	https://goutsa.com/news/2010/01/20/utsa-hires-travis-bush-as-offensive-coordinator ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2011_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team ; https://paisano-online.com/426/sports/utsa-hires-travis-bush-as-offensive-coordinator/
Feb 2012–Sep 3 2012	Houston	Running backs coach	HC Tony Levine; OC Mike Nesbitt	https://uhcougars.com/news/2012/2/11/Houston_s_Levine_Completes_Football_Coaching_Staff
Sep 2012–Dec 2012	Houston	Offensive coordinator + QBs (play-caller) after Nesbitt resigned following 30-13 loss to Texas State; Wikipedia labels it "interim"	HC Tony Levine	https://uhcougars.com/news/2012/9/3/Levine_Announces_Staff_Changes ; https://thedailycougar.com/2012/09/04/nesbitt-resigns-as-offensive-coordinator-on-heels-of-loss-to-texas-state/ ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2012_Houston_Cougars_football_team
2013	Houston	Assistant head coach + co-offensive coordinator (QBs); Doug Meacham hired as OC/co-OC Jan 2013. **Disagreement**: Wikipedia lists Meacham as sole OC in 2013; TCU's hire release calls Meacham "co-OC/QBs"	HC Tony Levine; OC Doug Meacham	https://uhcougars.com/news/2013/1/14/Doug_Meacham_Named_Houston_Offensive_Coordinator ; https://gofrogs.com/news/2013/12/12/Meacham_Hired_as_Offensive_Coordinator ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2013_Houston_Cougars_football_team

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
2014	Houston	Assistant HC / offensive coordinator / QBs (title per Bills 2015 release); Levine fired Dec 8, 2014	HC Tony Levine	https://www.buffalobills.com/news/bills-name-2015-bill-walsh-minority-coaching-fellowship-participants-15410462 ; https://gocoogs.com/?p=15368 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tony_Levine
2015	Buffalo Bills	Bill Walsh Minority Coaching Fellowship participant, worked with RBs at minicamp/training camp (Bills release). UTRGV bio calls it "offensive assistant… running backs and advanced game-plan studies." Full-season status: **unverified**	HC Rex Ryan; OC Greg Roman; asst HC/RBs Anthony Lynn	https://www.buffalobills.com/news/bills-name-2015-bill-walsh-minority-coaching-fellowship-participants-15410462 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/travis-bush/722 ; https://www.buffalorumblings.com/bills-news-notes/2015/1/26/7907955/rex-ryan-buffalo-bills-coaching-staff-confirmed-hires
2016–20 (UTRGV release: 2016–21, calendar)	Seguin HS	Head coach / athletic director; 2-8, 2-8, 7-4 (2018 district title, first since 2006), 2020 shared 12-5A-I title, program-record 52 ppg; 23-29, 3 playoff trips	n/a	https://herald-zeitung.com/community_alert/canyon-pulls-its-new-football-coach-from-seguin/article_5615e76c-77d6-11eb-97d4-fb931b6b7f36.html ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Travis_Bush
Feb 2021–Dec 2022	New Braunfels Canyon HS	Head coach / athletic coordinator; 4-6 (2021), 9-2 and 2nd in 12-5A-I (2022). HS career 36-37	n/a	https://www.seguin.k12.tx.us/page/article/6470 ; https://herald-zeitung.com/sports/bush-leaves-canyon-for-utrgv-position/article_e9cf9af4-7a9d-11ed-8ded-3b30583e2ebd.html ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Travis_Bush
Dec 12 2022–present	UTRGV	First head coach in program history; 2025: 9-3 (5-3 SLC), T-3rd, unbeaten at home; 6th in Eddie Robinson Award vote; extended through 2030 (Dec 2025); hired Theron Aych as co-OC (Jan 2026)	n/a	https://goutrgv.com/news/2022/12/12/travis-bush-named-first-head-football-coach.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UT_Rio_Grande_Valley_Vaqueros_football_team ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/15/football-utrgv-athletics-inks-coach-bush-to-contract-extension.aspx ; https://www.footballscoop.com/2026/01/15/sources-emerging-fcs-power-lands-big-12-assistant

Tree / mentors

- Gary Patterson (TCU, 2001–03): defensive-minded HC; Bush was an offensive GA on the OL side. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gary_Patterson
- David Bailiff (Texas State 2004–06, later Rice): Bush's first full-time job, coaching WRs; Bailiff's co-OCs were Blake Miller/Frank Hernandez. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2006_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team
- Brad Wright (Texas State 2007–10): promoted Bush to associate HC/co-OC with Ben Norton. Scheme listed only as "Multiple"; Bush's bio says the 2008 unit was 4th in FCS scoring and 5th in total offense, and 2009 was 8th in pass offense (289 ypg) and 12th in total offense (422 ypg), i.e., a pass-leaning attack. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Brad_Wright_(American_football) ; https://goutsa.com/staff/travis-bush ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2010_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team
- Larry Coker (UTSA 2010–11): national-title HC (Miami) who hired Bush to build the start-up offense; UTSA 2011 listed as a spread. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2011_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team
- Tony Levine (Houston 2012–14): Bush was his play-caller, QB coach and assistant HC; Doug Meacham (Air Raid lineage, later TCU OC) was co-OC in 2013. https://uhcougars.com/news/2013/1/14/Doug_Meacham_Named_Houston_Offensive_Coordinator
- Rex Ryan / Greg Roman / Anthony Lynn (Bills 2015): Bush sat in the RB room under Lynn in Roman's run-first offense. https://www.buffalorumblings.com/bills-news-notes/2015/1/26/7907955/rex-ryan-buffalo-bills-coaching-staff-confirmed-hires

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Texas State WRs, 2004–06

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Barrick Nealy (not Bush's group)	QB	2005	Pro (UDFA/other)	6 AA/POY		2005 Southland Player of the Year; UDFA Vikings as WR 2006; CFL Calgary 2006–10	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barrick_Nealy
2	Markee White (6-7, 205, Long Beach CA)	WR	2005	Pro (UDFA/other)	5 1st team		First-team All-Southland 2005; UDFA St. Louis Rams 2007; long Arena/AFL career	https://lionsports.net/news/2005/11/22/95785016 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Markee_White

LOW:

not found

none documented (thin). 2004 and 2006 All-SLC lists not retrieved.

Texas State co-OC/QBs, 2007–09

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Cameron Luke	WR	2008		6 AA/POY		AP 3rd-team All-American; 1st-team All-SLC; 73 rec, 1,268 yds, 17 TD (4th in FCS); school single-season rec/yds records; SLC career TD-reception record; career 142-2,431-32	https://txst.com/news/2008/12/17/121708aaa_632 ; https://txst.com/news/2008/11/26/112608aag_904
2	Bradley George	QB	2006–09		6 AA/POY		2009 Southland Offensive Player of the Year (3,121 yds, 23 TD, 63%, 6th nationally in pass efficiency); school career passing leader; HM All-SLC 2008 & 2009; TXST Hall of Honor 2022	https://txst.com/news/2009/11/24/112409aaa_91 ; https://txst.com/news/2022/11/25/-t-association-states-up-bradley-george
3	Karrington Bush	RB/RS	2008–09		5 1st team		1st-team All-SLC RB 2008 (soph); 2nd-team return specialist 2009	https://txst.com/news/2008/11/26/112608aag_904 ; https://txst.com/news/2009/11/24/112409aaa_91

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
4	Blake Burton / Jeff Bowen	FB / C	2008		5 1st team		1st-team All-SLC (2008 SLC champions, FCS playoffs; 9 Bobcats all-conference)	https://txst.com/news/2008/11/26/112608aag_904
5	Da'Marcus Griggs	WR	2007–09 (roster years unverified)		5 1st team		2010 preseason 1st-team All-SLC	https://www.southland.org/news/2010/7/28/34127.aspx

LOW:

not found

none documented. No QB-competition or transfer case surfaced for 2007–09.

UTSA OC/QBs, 2011 (thin; independent, no all-conference team)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Eric Soza	QB	2011 (soph)		2 record/led team		2,148 yds and 14 TD, 9th-best single season in UTSA history at the time; opener: 237 pass yds + 108 rush yds; career 46 TD 2011–13	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UTSA_Roadrunners_football_statistical_leaders ; https://static.goutsa.com/stats/football/2011/game01.htm
2	David Glasco II	RB	2011				Primary rusher in box scores; no honor found	https://static.goutsa.com/stats/football/2011/game10.htm

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	Ryan Polite	QB	2011–12		1 stats		RS-freshman spot starter for injured Soza in 2011; set school single-game record (302 yds) in 2012, then left for Trinity Valley CC and Southeastern Oklahoma State (timing/reason not documented; weak "low" case)	https://goutsa.com/sports/football/roster/player/ryan-polite ; https://goutsa.com/news/2012/10/20/san-jose-state-overwhelms-utsa-on-saturday-52-24 ; https://gosoutheastern.com/roster.aspx?rp_id=1745

Houston RBs (Game 1) then OC/QBs, 2012

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Charles Sims	RB	2012	NFL	5 1st team		2nd-team All-C-USA; 1,224 scrimmage yds, 14 TD; grad-transferred to West Virginia (1st-team All-Big 12, Big 12 Newcomer of the Year 2013); Tampa Bay 3rd round, No. 69, 2014	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Charles_Sims_(American_football ; https://www.sports-reference.com/cfb/players/charles-sims-1.html ; https://wvusports.com/news/2014/5/9/25764_131465985597442354
2	Deontay Greenberry	WR	2012 (Fr)		4 2nd team/FOY		C-USA All-Freshman team; 47 rec/569 yds led league freshmen; former long-time Notre Dame commit who flipped to UH	https://uhcougars.com/news/2012/12/4/Houston_Places_13_on_Conference_USA_All_Conference_Teams ; https://mauth.cbssports.com/college-football/news/cbs-2012-preseason-all-conference-usa-team/
3	Larry McDuffey	WR	2012 (Fr)		4 2nd team/FOY		C-USA All-Freshman team (28 rec, 382 yds, 4 TD); UH placed 13 on All-C-USA teams	https://uhcougars.com/news/2012/12/4/Houston_Places_13_on_Conference_USA_All_Conference_Teams

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	David Piland	QB	2012–13		1 stats		Incumbent starter; benched for final two games of 2012, lost job to Crawford Jones; regained job in 2013 preseason but freshman O'Korn started most of 2013; Rivals wrote he "will not be the guy" (transfer unverified)	https://thedailycougar.com/2013/04/15/piland-takes-challenge-of-regaining-starting-spot/ ; https://houston.rivals.com/news/future-forecast-quarterbacks

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
2	Charles Sims (departure)	RB	2012				Left UH after Bush's one season as his RB coach/OC for WVU (graduate transfer; not a performance failure)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Charles_Sims_(American_football

Houston asst HC / co-OC / QBs 2013; OC / QBs 2014

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Deontay Greenberry	WR	2013–14	Pro (UDFA/other)	5 1st team	67.4 (2014 receiving)	1st-team All-AAC 2013 (76 rec, led league at 100.5 ypg); 2nd-team All-AAC 2014; Biletnikoff watch list; UDFA 2015	https://uhcougars.com/news/2013/12/11/Seven_Cougars_Earn_Honors_from_The_American_Athletic_Conference ; https://uhcougars.com/news/2014/12/10/Seven_Named_to_The_American_All_Conference_Team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Deontay_Greenberry
2	Demarcus Ayers	KR/WR	2013 (Fr)		5 1st team		1st-team All-AAC KR	https://uhcougars.com/news/2013/12/11/Seven_Cougars_Earn_Honors_from_The_American_Athletic_Conference
3	John O'Korn	QB	2013 (Fr)		4 2nd team/FOY		AAC Rookie of the Year; 3,117 yds, 28 TD; 8-5, BBVA Compass Bowl; offense 15th nationally (479.6 ypg, 32.4 ppg)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_O%27Korn ; https://www.foxnews.com/sports/ncaa-football-preview-houston-cougars
4	Kenneth Farrow	RB	2014		2 record/led team	84.9 (2014 rushing)	12 rushing TD (2nd-best single season in AAC history then), six 100-yd games	https://uhcougars.com/news/2014/12/6/Postgame_Notes_Cincinnati_38_Houston_31
5	Greg Ward Jr.	QB (converted WR)	2014 (Soph)		1 stats	75.8 (2014 passing)	Took over for O'Korn midseason; 29/33 vs Temple; 360 pass + 84 rush vs Cincinnati; UH 7-5, Armed Forces Bowl	https://uhcougars.com/news/2014/10/18/Postgame_Notes_Houston_31_Temple_10 ; https://uhcougars.com/news/2014/12/6/Postgame_Notes_Cincinnati_38_Houston_31

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
6	Daniel Spencer	WR	2013–14		1 stats	62.8 (2014 receiving)	13 games/11 starts 2013; 2014 Biletnikoff watch list; no all-conference found	https://uhcougars.com/news/2014/7/15/Houston_Duo_Named_to_Biletnikoff_Award_Watch_List

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	John O'Korn	QB	2014		1 stats	45.5 (2014 passing)	Benched five games in (≈50% comp, 6 TD/8 INT) for Ward; Wikipedia blames scheme change after Meacham left; GoCoogs (opinion) blames Bush's 15-lb muscle plan; transferred to Michigan Feb 5, 2015	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/John_O%27Korn ; https://www.si.com/college/2015/01/08/john-okorn-houston-cougars-transferring ; https://thedailycougar.com/2015/02/05/okorn-announces-transfer-to-michigan/ ; https://gocoogs.com/?p=15368
2	Offense as a whole	—	2014		1 stats		29.3 ppg, 59th nationally (vs 32.4/15th in 2013); staff fired Dec 8, 2014	https://www.foxnews.com/sports/ncaa-football-preview-houston-cougars ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tony_Levine

Buffalo Bills RB room, 2015 (attribution weak: fellowship/offensive assistant under RB coach Anthony Lynn)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	LeSean McCoy	RB	2015	NFL	2 record/led team		Pro Bowl (4th career); team-high 895 rush yds; 22 broken tackles on 132 carries midseason	https://www.buffalorumblings.com/2015/12/22/10655876/buffalo-bills-lesean-mccoy-selected-to-pro-bowl ; https://www.pff.com/news/pro-bills-find-balance-in-backfield-with-mccoy-and-williams

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
2	Karlos Williams	RB	2015 (5th-rd rookie)	NFL	1 stats		TD in each of first six NFL games (tied record); 517 yds, 7 rush TD + 2 rec TD, 5.8 ypc	https://www.buffalobills.com/news/karlos-williams-carving-out-spot-in-record-books-16286863 ; https://www.nfl.com/_amp/lesean-mccoy-karlos-williams-duo-fueling-bills-o-0ap3000000578966

LOW:

not found

none during 2015 (Williams' 2016 suspension/release post-dates Bush).

Seguin HS, 2016–20 (thin)

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

no named signees found; program outcomes only (2018 district title, 2020 shared title, 52 ppg record). https://herald-zeitung.com/community_alert/canyon-pulls-its-new-football-coach-from-seguin/article_5615e76c-77d6-11eb-97d4-fb931b6b7f36.html

New Braunfels Canyon HS, 2021–22 (thin)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Deuce Adams	QB	2022 (Jr)		1 stats		66.9%, 3,007 yds, 34 TD, 6 INT, 290 rush yds; Rivals No. 29 QB / No. 97 in Texas; committed Louisville Apr 2023; played senior year at Vandegrift after family moved; 2026 Wisconsin roster (single source)	https://n.rivals.com/news/louisville-lands-central-texas-playmaker-qb-deuce-adams ; https://herald-zeitung.com/sports/cougars-rout-titans-55-29-in-victoria/article_4423e3b2-2c96-11ed-9691-5bf0c67272cf.html ; https://www.texasfootball.com/article/2023/04/30/hot-100-qb-and-twin-brother-join-state-championship-contender

LOW:

not found

Note: Canyon's April 2021 signees (Gomez–Concordia NE, Payne–Hardin-Simmons, Williford–Wayland Baptist) predate Bush's first season (hired Feb 2021). https://www.comalisd.org/apps/news/article/1427479

UTRGV, 2025 (HC)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Eddie Lee Marburger	QB	2025 (Sr)		6 AA/POY		1st-team All-SLC; SLC Newcomer of the Year; Phil Steele SLC OPOY; DCTF Texas Non-FBS OPOY; 2,780 yds, 31 pass TD, 4 rush TD, 7 INT	https://www.southland.org/news/2025/11/25/southland-announces-2025-all-conference-football-team-and-superlatives.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/22/football-marburger-named-dctf-texas-non-fbs-offensive-player-of-the-year.aspx
2	Tony Diaz	WR	2025 (Fr)		6 AA/POY		1st-team All-SLC; SLC Freshman of the Year; FCS Football Central Freshman All-American	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/8/utrgv-leads-2025-fcs-football-central-freshman-all-american-team-with-four-selections.aspx
3	Nick Hughes	OL	2025 (Fr)		6 AA/POY		2nd-team All-SLC, started all 12; Freshman All-American	not found
4	Nathaniel Wallace-Dilling	P	2025		4 2nd team/FOY		2nd-team All-SLC	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/11/25/football-marburger-diaz-earn-major-southland-awards.aspx

LOW:

not found

none documented in year one.

Archetype read

- Bush's best offensive players are pass-game producers: a 6-7 WR (White), a 17-TD All-American WR (Luke), a 100-ypg WR (Greenberry), a conference OPOY QB (George), a freshman 3,100-yd QB (O'Korn) and a 31-TD transfer QB (Marburger). Volume passing production, not size at RB, is the recurring signal.
- QB profile skews toward accurate, moderately mobile passers who can run when needed (George 63%, Soza 108 rush yds in a game, Ward converted from WR with Wildcat usage, Marburger 4 rush TD); the one classic drop-back in the set (O'Korn) is the one who was benched.
- Recruiting pedigree is mixed: Greenberry was a national (Notre Dame) recruit; Luke, George, Karrington Bush, Soza and Marburger were FCS/G5-level or transfer pieces. Bush's units have produced honors from lightly recruited Texans as often as from blue-chips.
- Home state: nearly every named player is a Texas HS product or Texas-college transfer (Luke, George, Sims, Ward, Farrow, Adams, Marburger; Greenberry from California is the exception); UTRGV 2025 continued this with Texas freshmen earning All-American nods.
- Origin: Texas State and Houston stars were HS-direct developmental players who peaked as sophomores/juniors; UTRGV's first-year stars were a portal QB plus true freshmen, suggesting Bush will pair an experienced transfer QB with HS skill talent.
- Where the pattern broke: the two documented "lows" are QBs in year two of a system (Piland 2012, O'Korn 2014), both losing jobs to more mobile replacements (Jones, Ward). Projection risk for Bush is highest at pocket QB after a staff/scheme change.

What Bush's own tree says about his HC archetype

- Texas State (Bailiff/Wright, 2004–09): scheme listed as "Multiple," but Bush's own co-OC units ranked 4th in FCS scoring (2008) and 8th in pass offense (2009); the rewarded profile was a big, record-setting WR (Luke) and an efficient multi-year QB (George). https://goutsa.com/staff/travis-bush ; https://txst.com/news/2008/12/17/121708aaa_632
- UTSA (Coker, 2011): start-up spread with a sophomore QB who ran and threw (Soza 237/108 in game one); a start-from-scratch blueprint he explicitly cited when taking UTRGV. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2011_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team ; https://texasfootball.com/article/2023/07/25/bush-sees-similarities-and-differences-between-utsa-and-utrgv

- Houston (Levine, 2012–14): tempo spread with Air Raid influence (Meacham co-OC 2013); rewarded high-volume WRs (Greenberry 76 rec) and a freshman QB throwing 28 TD; the 2014 Wildcat/Ward package shows willingness to play a converted athlete at QB. https://uhcougars.com/news/2013/1/14/Doug_Meacham_Named_Houston_Offensive_Coordinator ; https://thedailycougar.com/2014/09/11/insertion-ward-wildcat-package-takes-pressure-okorn/
- Buffalo (Ryan/Roman/Lynn, 2015): run-first, two-back "balance in the backfield" with elite broken-tackle backs (McCoy, Williams 5.8 ypc); his one exposure to a power-run NFL system. https://www.pff.com/news/pro-bills-find-balance-in-backfield-with-mccoy-and-williams
- High school (Seguin/Canyon): 52-ppg district champion at Seguin and a 3,000-yd/34-TD QB at Canyon who became a P4 signee, consistent with a QB-centric spread. https://n.rivals.com/news/louisville-lands-central-texas-playmaker-qb-deuce-adams
- UTRGV 2025 synthesizes it: portal QB (Newcomer of the Year) + freshman WR (Freshman of the Year) + freshman OL All-American; 9-3 and sixth in Eddie Robinson voting, and he added a Big 12 assistant (Aych) as co-OC. https://www.southland.org/news/2025/11/25/southland-announces-2025-all-conference-football-team-and-superlatives.aspx ; https://www.footballscoop.com/2026/01/15/sources-emerging-fcs-power-lands-big-12-assistant

Confidence: Timeline Medium-High (stops and mentors are triple-sourced; exact years at TCU 2003 vs 2004, Texas State 2009 vs 2010, 2013 OC vs co-OC title, and Bills full-season status are disputed). Players Medium (Texas State 2008–09, Houston and UTRGV lists come from official releases; UTSA, 2004–06 Texas State, Seguin and Bills attribution are thin or indirect).

Gaps: San Marcos HS stint (not found). TCU OC 2001–03 and 2004/2006/2007 All-SLC Texas State honorees. Full 2011 UTSA season totals. 2014 All-AAC names beyond Greenberry. Seguin signees (none found). Marburger's prior school/hometown. Cameron Luke's pro status.

Brian Gamble — Assistant Head Coach / Defensive Coordinator / Linebackers

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
1999–2002	Texas A&M	Player, LB (4-yr letterman; 47 starts, 46 consecutive; 341 tackles; 1999 Big 12 Freshman of the Year; led team w/ 110 tackles in 2000; 2001 preseason 3rd-team AA; 2002 defensive captain, Butkus watch list)	HC R.C. Slocum	https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/1619 ; https://latechsports.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/464 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/R._C._Slocum
2004	Kilgore College (JUCO)	Linebackers coach (10-2, No. 5 ranking)	HC not found	https://latechsports.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/464
2005–07	Houston	Graduate assistant (2006 C-USA champions, 10-4)	HC not confirmed in results (Art Briles, unverified)	https://latechsports.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/464 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/brian-gamble/730
2008–11	Incarnate Word (D-II, LSC from 2010)	Defensive line coach (on UIW's original staff)	HC Mike Santiago (parted ways Oct 25, 2011); DC Todd Ivicic (2009; base 4-2-5)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mike_Santiago_(American_football ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2009_Incarnate_Word_Cardinals_football_team ; https://rgvsports.com/?p=224720
2012–17	Incarnate Word (LSC 2012; D-I indep. 2013; Southland 2014–17)	Defensive coordinator (installed 3-4)	HC Larry Kennan	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/621 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2016_Incarnate_Word_Cardinals_football_team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2015_Incarnate_Word_Cardinals_football_team
2018–20	Louisiana Tech	Linebackers coach (23-13; 10-win 2019; 14-0 Independence Bowl win over Miami)	HC Skip Holtz; DC not found in results (Blake Baker / Bob Diaco unverified)	https://crescentcitysports.com/la-tech-announces-gamble-as-linebackers-coach/ ; https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/1619
2021–22	Texas State	Inside linebackers coach	HC Jake Spavital; DC Zac Spavital (Wikipedia lists base 3-4; a CFN article calls it 4-2-5 — disagreement)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_Texas_State_Bobcats_football_team ; https://collegefootballnetwork.com/texas-state-recruiting-big-12-commits/
2023–present	UTRGV	Asst. HC / DC / LB (goutrgv.com says "first assistant head coach"; 2023 DCTF and AFCA bios list only DC/LB — title disagreement)	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/brian-gamble/730 ; https://texasfootball.com/article/2023/03/08/utrgv-names-defensive-coordinator ; https://convention.afca.com/?p=3148

Tree / mentors

- R.C. Slocum (Texas A&M, "Wrecking Crew" era) — played LB 1999–2002 (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/R._C._Slocum).
- Mike Santiago (UIW founding HC, 2008–11) and Todd Ivicic (UIW DC 2009, 4-2-5) — Gamble's DL years (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2009_Incarnate_Word_Cardinals_football_team).
- Larry Kennan (UIW HC 2012–17, ex-NFL coordinator) — promoted Gamble to DC; Gamble converted UIW to a 3-4 front, first season allowed no 500-yard games, 2013 produced back-to-back shutouts (Texas College, Langston), first in school history (https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/621).
- Skip Holtz (La Tech HC) — LB coach 2018–20 (https://crescentcitysports.com/la-tech-announces-gamble-as-linebackers-coach/).
- Jake Spavital / Zac Spavital (Texas State) — ILB coach 2021–22; bio credits "best defensive production in program's FBS history (since 2012)" in 2022 (https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/1619).
- Travis Bush (UTRGV) — describes scheme as "attacking style of defense with multiple fronts and coverages" (https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/brian-gamble/730).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Incarnate Word, 2008–17 (DL coach then DC) — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

not found (all-LSC/all-Southland lists for 2010–17 could not be retrieved before the search budget ran out).

Louisiana Tech, 2018–20 (LB)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Trey Baldwin	LB	2020		4 2nd team/FOY	72.3 (2020 defense)	2nd-team All-C-USA, Phil Steele 3rd team; 85 tackles, team-best 53 solo	https://www.pressreader.com/usa/el-dorado-news-times/20210416/281947430677804
2	Tyler Grubbs	LB	2020 (Fr.)		4 2nd team/FOY	68.3 (2020 defense)	2nd-team All-C-USA, Phil Steele 2nd team, C-USA All-Freshman; team-best 99 tackles (one La Tech release says 1st team — disagreement)	https://latechsports.com/news/2021/1/5/football-louisiana-tech-has-12-bulldogs-represented-on-phil-steele-all-conference-usa-teams.aspx ; https://www.pressreader.com/usa/el-dorado-news-times/20210416/281947430677804
3	Ezekiel Barnett	LB	by 2020		3 HM/3rd	76.0 (2020 defense)	HM All-C-USA; Burlsworth Trophy nominee (walk-on award)	https://www.pressreader.com/usa/el-dorado-news-times/20210416/281947430677804
4	Connor Taylor	LB	2018–20		3 HM/3rd	74.5 (2019 defense)	HM All-C-USA (season unspecified)	https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/1619
5	Willie Baker	LB	2018–20		3 HM/3rd	74.4 (2018 defense)	HM All-C-USA (season unspecified)	https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/brian-gamble/1619
6	Collin Scott	LB	2018–19		3 HM/3rd	69.7 (2018 defense)	HM All-C-USA 2018 and 2019; 12 starts, 65 tackles in 2019	https://latechsports.com/roster.aspx?rp_id=2865

LOW:

not found

Texas State, 2021–22 (ILB)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	(Jordan Revels)	OLB	2022		3 HM/3rd		HM All-Sun Belt, Phil Steele 4th team — note: OLB, likely not Gamble's room	https://txst.com/news/2022/12/1/football-bell-hergel-named-all-sun-belt-4-others-pick-up-honorable-mention.aspx
2	Brian Holloway	ILB	2022		1 stats	74.1 (2022 defense)	SMU transfer; 49 tackles, 5.0 TFL, 1.0 sack; one of two starting ILBs in a front seven described as among Sun Belt's best; graduated	https://txst.com/news/2023/3/31/athletics-states-up-podcast-brian-holloway.aspx ; https://collegefootballnetwork.com/texas-state-recruiting-big-12-commits/
3	Dan Foster	ILB	2022				Starting ILB alongside Holloway	https://collegefootballnetwork.com/texas-state-recruiting-big-12-commits/

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	Dan Foster	ILB	2022				Transferred to Louisville after being a starter (exact offseason unverified)	https://collegefootballnetwork.com/texas-state-recruiting-big-12-commits/
2	Jordan Smith	LB	~2023 (unverified)				Navarro JUCO transfer who left after spring ball for the portal — may postdate Gamble's departure; unverified	https://collegefootballnetwork.com/texas-state-recruiting-big-12-commits/

UTRGV, 2025 (DC/LB)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Jaiden Haygood	LB	2025 (So.)		6 AA/POY		Team-high 102 tackles; Freshman All-American (FCS Football Central, Stats Perform, Phil Steele); Phil Steele 3rd-team All-Conf; Jerry Rice Award watch list; 2026 Phil Steele preseason 1st team	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/8/utrgv-leads-2025-fcs-football-central-freshman-all-american-team-with-four-selections.aspx ; https://www.krgv.com/news/utrgv-linebacker-jaiden-haygood-on-the-jerry-rice-award-watch-list ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/8/3/football-places-12-on-phil-steele-preseason-all-conference-teams.aspx
2	Alijah Prosser	DB	2025 (Fr.)		6 AA/POY		FCS Football Central Freshman AA; 2 INT, 1 sack, 2 FF	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/8/utrgv-leads-2025-fcs-football-central-freshman-all-american-team-with-four-selections.aspx
3	Ian Box	DE	2025 (Jr.)		4 2nd team/FOY		2nd-team All-Southland (defense-wide, under Gamble as DC)	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/11/25/football-marburger-diaz-earn-major-southland-awards.aspx

LOW:

not found

Unit: led Southland in five statistical categories; 2nd in FCS in fumbles recovered (https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/brian-gamble/730). Conference release counts UTRGV honorees as both “five” and “nine” — unresolved.

Archetype read

- Productive, high-volume tacklers rather than highly rated recruits: Grubbs (99), Baldwin (85), Haygood (102) all led or nearly led their teams in tackles; none of the listed players carried a documented 4-star rating.
- Developmental/overlooked origins: Barnett (Burlsworth = walk-on), Holloway (FBS transfer from SMU), Haygood (true freshman starter at a start-up FCS program).
- Gamble’s best LB seasons came early in a player’s career (Grubbs as a freshman, Haygood as a freshman/sophomore), suggesting he plays young, instinctive ILBs quickly.
- Scheme: he has run 3-4 fronts at UIW and Texas State (per Wikipedia) and “multiple fronts” at UTRGV; his ILBs are asked to stack tackles, which favors downhill run-fitters over coverage-first bodies.
- Home state: all documented UTRGV/Texas State players appear to be Texas-rooted (unverified for each), consistent with his A&M/Houston/UIW/Texas State roots.
- LOW break: Foster was a starter who transferred up (Louisville) — the pattern failure is retention of productive players, not evaluation.

Confidence: Timeline Medium (stops and years are consistent across four school bios; HC/DC at Houston and La Tech and the Kilgore HC are unconfirmed; UTRGV title wording disagrees). Players Low–Medium (La Tech and UTRGV lists are sourced; UIW is empty; Texas State honors list for 2021 not retrieved; LOW list is one documented transfer).

Gaps: UIW all-conference defenders 2010–17; La Tech DCs by year; Houston HC; Texas State 2021 ILB names/honors; any dismissals/benchings; recruiting star ratings for all players; 2025 official all-Southland full list.

Jeff Bowen — Co-Offensive Coordinator / Offensive Line

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
2005	East Texas Baptist (D-III)	Player, OL; team captain 2005, then transferred	not found	https://goutsa.com/staff/jeff-bowen
2006–08	Texas State	Player, C; 20 straight starts at C; 2008 1st-team All-Southland; The Sports Network HM All-American; John O'Hara Outstanding OL Award	HC not confirmed in results (David Bailiff 2006 / Brad Wright 2007–08 unverified); Travis Bush was on the Texas State staff 2006–08	https://txst.com/news/2008/11/26/112608aag_904 ; https://txst.com/news/2009/2/25/022509aaa_892 ; https://rgvsports.com/?p=224739
2010	Texas State	Graduate assistant, OL	HC not confirmed (Brad Wright unverified)	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/jeff-bowen/732 ; https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/1387
2011–13	UTSA	Graduate assistant, offense/OL (program's first three seasons)	HC Larry Coker; OC Travis Bush (2011), Kevin Brown (2012–13)	https://goutsa.com/staff/jeff-bowen ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2011_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2013_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team
2014–15	Northwestern State	Tight ends / assistant OL	HC Jay Thomas; OC not found	https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/1387 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jay_Thomas_(American_football
2016	Northeastern Oklahoma A&M (JUCO)	Offensive line coach (40 ppg, 530 ypg; +~7 ppg, +130 ypg YoY)	HC Clay Patterson	https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/1060 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Clay_Patterson
2017	Northwestern State	Offensive line coach (offense improved in total and scoring offense)	HC Jay Thomas (5th/final yr); OC Kyle Manley	https://nsudemons.com/coaches.aspx?rc=1387 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2017_Northwestern_State_Demons_football_team
2018	Stephen F. Austin	Tight ends coach (2-8)	HC Clint Conque (suspended June, resigned Aug 6) → interim HC Jeff Byrd; OC Kevin Barbay, co-OC Jeremy Moses	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/jeff-bowen/732 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2018_Stephen_F._Austin_Lumberjacks_football_team
2019–22	Northeastern State (D-II, MIAA)	Offensive coordinator / OL (four seasons)	HC not found in results (Tom Howe unverified)	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/jeff-bowen/732 ; https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/437
2023–present	UTRGV	OC/OL (hired March 27, 2023, announced as OL coach; listed OC in 2025); Co-OC/OL with Theron Aych in 2026	HC Travis Bush	https://rgvsports.com/?p=224739 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/jeff-bowen/732 ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/coaches/2026

Tree / mentors

- Travis Bush — on Texas State staff while Bowen played (2006–08), his OC at UTSA (2011), and his HC at UTRGV; the defining relationship (https://rgvsports.com/?p=224739).
- Larry Coker (UTSA founding HC) / Kevin Brown (UTSA OC 2012–13) — start-up program experience that Bush cited when hiring him for UTRGV's start-up (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2013_UTSA_Roadrunners_football_team).
- Jay Thomas (Northwestern State HC) and Kyle Manley (NSU OC 2017) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2017_Northwestern_State_Demons_football_team).
- Clay Patterson (NEO A&M HC 2016) — high-tempo JUCO offense, 40 ppg (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Clay_Patterson).
- Kevin Barbay / Jeremy Moses (SFA 2018 OC/co-OC) under Conque then Byrd.

- Scheme: no documented system label; 2025 UTRGV offense protected Walter Payton Award finalist QB Eddie Lee Marburger and allowed 1.50 sacks/game (28th or 30th in FCS — sources disagree; 2nd in Southland) (https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/2/bowen-named-footballscoop-fcs-coordinator-of-the-year-finalist.aspx).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Northwestern State, 2014–15 (TE) and 2017 (OL) — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

not found. LOW: not found.

Northeastern Oklahoma A&M, 2016 (OL) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Larry Joubert	OL	2016		5 1st team		1st-team all-conference; signed with Oklahoma State	https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/1060
2	Sammy Bernard	OL	2016		5 1st team		1st-team all-conference; signed with New Mexico	https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/jeff-bowen/1060
3	(two more unnamed)	OL	2016		1 stats		4 of 5 sophomore OL signed with FBS programs	not found

LOW:

not found

Stephen F. Austin, 2018 (TE) — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

none; no SFA tight end on the 2018 All-Southland teams (https://www.southland.org/news/2018/11/20/southland-announces-2018-all-conference-football-teams.aspx).

Northeastern State, 2019–22 (OC/OL) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Madison Wrather	OL	2019–21		6 AA/POY		HM All-MIAA 2021; CoSIDA Academic All-America 1st team; 24 consecutive starts; 11 starts in 2019	https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/madison-wrather/3948 ; https://goriverhawksgo.com/news/2021/9/15/football-northeastern-state-hosts-pitt-state-saturday.aspx

LOW:

not found

Note: 2022 NSU all-MIAA list (6 players) contained no offensive linemen (https://goriverhawksgo.com/news/2022/11/15/football-lamotte-highlights-six-all-miaa-selection.aspx).

UTRGV, 2025 (OC/OL)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Nick Hughes	OL	2025 (Fr.)		6 AA/POY		2nd-team All-Southland; FCS Football Central Freshman All-American; 2026 Phil Steele preseason 1st team	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/11/25/football-marburger-diaz-earn-major-southland-awards.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/8/utrgv-leads-2025-fcs-football-central-freshman-all-american-team-with-four-selections.aspx
2	Eddie Lee Marburger	QB (unit outcome)	2025		6 AA/POY		Walter Payton Award finalist behind Bowen's line	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/2/bowen-named-footballscoop-fcs-coordinator-of-the-year-finalist.aspx
3	Wes Thompson	OL	2025 (Sr. in 2026)		5 1st team		2026 Phil Steele preseason 1st-team All-Southland	https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/8/3/football-places-12-on-phil-steele-preseason-all-conference-teams.aspx
4	Abram Nicklas	OL	2025 (5th-yr in 2026)		4 2nd team/FOY		2026 Phil Steele preseason 2nd-team All-Southland	not found

LOW:

not found

Archetype read

- Bowen's documented OL standouts skew young and developmental: Hughes earned all-conference honors as a true freshman; Joubert and Bernard were JUCO sophomores he moved to FBS within one season.
- JUCO-to-FBS pipeline is his clearest track record (4 of 5 NEO sophomores signed FBS), and his UTRGV line mixes a freshman (Hughes) with a fifth-year (Nicklas) — he builds lines from both ends of the age spectrum rather than from blue-chip HS recruits.
- Pass protection is the measurable output at UTRGV (1.50 sacks/game, 2nd in Southland), consistent with his own background as a 20-start center.
- Academic/durability profile: Wrather (CoSIDA Academic AA, 24 straight starts) and Bowen himself (20 straight starts) suggest a preference for reliable, high-availability interior players.
- Home state: Texas/Oklahoma pipeline (UTSA, Texas State, NEO, SFA, UTRGV); not verified per player.
- LOW break: none documented — no evidence found of a highly rated OL busting or transferring out under him.

Confidence: Timeline Medium (seven consistent school bios; HC names at Texas State 2006–10 and Northeastern State 2019–22 not confirmed; UTRGV title shifted OL coach → OC → co-OC). Players Low (only UTRGV 2025 and NEO 2016 have named honorees; NSU, SFA and most of Northeastern State are empty; no LOW performers found).

Gaps: Northeastern State HC 2019–22 and all-MIAA OL for 2019/2021; NSU 2014–15/2017 OL and TE honorees; SFA 2018 TE names; Texas State HC during his playing/GA years; recruiting ratings and hometowns for all listed players; portal departures from UTRGV's 2025 OL.

Theron Aych — Co-Offensive Coordinator / Quarterbacks Coach

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
~1992-96	Northern State (SD)	Player, WR (graduated 1996)	n/a	https://arizonawildcats.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/5148
1995-96	Aberdeen Central HS (SD)	Assistant coach	HC not found	https://gohuskies.com/sports/2013/4/18/208224272 ; https://okstate.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/3569
1997	Mesabi Range CC (MN)	OC / QBs	HC not found	https://okstate.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/3569
1998-99	Fort Scott CC (KS)	Assistant head coach	HC not found	https://gohuskies.com/sports/2013/4/18/208224272
2000-02	Houston	Offensive GA (UW bio instead says "running backs coach" — sources disagree)	HC Dana Dimel (unverified)	https://okstate.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/3569 ; https://gohuskies.com/sports/2013/4/18/208224272
2003 (one source: two seasons)	Washington	Defensive GA	HC Keith Gilbertson (unverified)	https://arizonawildcats.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/5148
2004-07 (Arizona bio: 2005-08; another: 2003-04)	Central Missouri (D2, MIAA)	Special teams / WRs	HC Willie Fritz (unverified)	https://arizonawildcats.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/5148 ; https://utepminers.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/2682
2008/09-10	not found	gap in every bio	—	not found
2011-15	Angelo State (D2, LSC)	Assistant HC / OC	HC Will Wagner	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2012_Angelo_State_Rams_football_team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Will_Wagner_(American_football
2016	UTEP	WRs	HC Sean Kugler; OC Brent Pease	https://www.theprospectordaily.com/2016/01/19/kugler-adds-four-new-coaches-to-his-staff/
2017-20	Arizona	WRs (2017, Rich Rodriguez); retained Jan 2018; "Assistant Coach/Inside Receivers" 2019; WRs/TEs per OSU bio	HC Rich Rodriguez (2017), Kevin Sumlin (2018-20)	https://arizonawildcats.com/news/2017/2/25/football-theron-aych-named-receivers-coach ; https://arizonawildcats.com/sports/football/roster/2019
2021	UTEP	Inside WRs	HC Dana Dimel (unverified)	https://utepminers.com/news/2021/2/15/football-utep-names-theron-aych-as-inside-wr-coach.aspx
2022-23	Tennessee State (FCS)	Offensive coordinator (replaced Hue Jackson); pro-style scheme	HC Eddie George	https://hbcugameday.com/2022/01/13/tennessee-state-hires-utep-coach-as-offensive-coordinator/ ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_Tennessee_State_Tigers_football_team
2024	Marshall	Offensive quality-control analyst (10-3, Sun Belt champs)	HC Charles Huff (unverified)	https://okstate.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/3569
2025	Oklahoma State	WRs	HC Mike Gundy (fired Sept 2025); OC/interim HC Doug Meacham	https://okstate.com/news/2025/1/15/cowboy-football-assistant-coaches-added-to-oklahoma-state-football-staff ; https://www.espn.com/college-football/story/_/id/46387685/mike-gundy-oklahoma-state-cowboys-fired-move

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
2026-	UTRGV	Co-OC / QBs / play-caller	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/1/15/football-hires-theron-aych-as-co-offensive-coordinator.aspx ; https://www.texasfootball.com/article/2026/08/11/utrgv-2026-preview

Tree / mentors

- Will Wagner (Angelo State HC 2011-18): Aych's only coordinator stops before TSU; 2015 ASU offense led D2 (one source: 560 ypg), Aych named D2 AFCA Assistant Coach of the Year finalist 2015 (https://arizonawildcats.com/news/2017/2/25/football-theron-aych-named-receivers-coach).
- Sean Kugler / Brent Pease (UTEP 2016): pro-style, run-first staff.
- Rich Rodriguez (Arizona 2017): spread/zone-read; Kevin Sumlin (2018-20): Air Raid lineage.
- Eddie George (TSU 2022-23): Wikipedia lists the 2022 scheme as pro-style.
- Mike Gundy / Doug Meacham (OSU 2025): Air Raid-derived spread. (Meacham was also Bush's co-OC at Houston in 2013: shared node in the two trees.)
- Travis Bush (UTRGV 2026): Aych now calls plays so Bush can work defense/ST (texasfootball.com).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Central Missouri, 2004-07 (WRs) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Delanie Walker	WR (college)	2004-05	NFL	1 stats		2006 NFL Draft (49ers); Pro Bowl TE with Titans; Aych was his position coach	https://okstate.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/3569

LOW:

not found

Angelo State, 2011-15 (OC) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Kyle Washington	QB	2012-15		6 AA/POY		2x LSC Offensive POY (2014, 2015); 3x All-LSC; Harlon Hill semifinalist 2014; ASU single-season record 3,691 pass yds + 27 TD + 831 rush yds (2015); 2014 LSC title	https://angelosports.com/sports/football/roster/kyle-washington/3305 ; https://muleriderathletics.com/staff-directory/kyle-washington/1301 ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/1/15/football-hires-theron-aych-as-co-offensive-coordinator.aspx

LOW:

not found

Other All-LSC offensive players 2011-15: not found.

UTEP, 2016 (WRs) — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

unit caught 21 TD, most since 2010 (https://arizonawildcats.com/news/2017/2/25/football-theron-aych-named-receivers-coach). Individual honors not found; roster names Warren Redix, Cole Freytag, Jaquan White (https://www.ktsm.com/sports/receivers-talk-about-the-utep-qb-battle/).

Arizona, 2017-20 (WRs/TEs, inside WRs)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Shawn Poindexter	WR (6-5 “late bloomer”)	2017-18	Pro (UDFA/other)	2 record/led team	83.7 (2018 receiving)	Led team in rec. yds 2018, tied school record 11 TD; 67-1,135-12 career; UDFA 49ers 2019	https://www.azdesertswarm.com/football/2019/4/27/18520286/shawn-poindexter-49ers-undrafted-free-agent-nfl-draft-arizona-wildcats-wide-receiver-contract; https://tucson.com/sports/arizona-wildcats/football/arizona-wildcats-battle-for-playing-time-at-receiver-is-wide/article_c95aeca1-3d2a-51c5-90f9-818694abc4d4.html
2	Stanley Berryhill III	WR	2018-20		2 record/led team	70.6 (2020 receiving)	Walk-on awarded scholarship 2018; led team 23 rec 2020	https://tucson.com/sports/arizona-wildcats/football/ex-arizona-receiver-stanley-berryhill-says-hes-transferring-to-ball-state/article_6ebe891e-4972-11eb-ba71-37f548c21b53.html
3	Jamarye Joiner	WR (converted QB)	2019-20		2 record/led team	64.7 (2019 receiving)	Led team 552 yds, 5 TD in 2019	https://tucson.com/sports/arizona-wildcats/football/it-s-about-the-team-the-motivation-behind-jamarye-joiner/article_81f858e5-8b6a-52ff-b109-eb9b8d3a8b3b.html
4	Shun Brown, Tony Ellison, Cedric Peterson (+Poindexter)	WR	2017-18		1 stats		Starters; combined 108-1,522-12 in 2017; unit led Pac-12 in yds/reception 2018	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/theron-aych/4367

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	Stanley Berryhill III	WR	2018-20		1 stats	70.6 (2020 receiving)	Announced transfer to Ball State Dec 2020 (later status unverified)	not found
2	Jamarye Joiner	WR	2019-20		1 stats	64.7 (2019 receiving)	Said he was leaving program Dec 2020; a 2022 article has him entering portal again (conflict)	https://tucson.com/sports/arizona-wildcats/football/arizona-wildcats-receiver-jamarye-joiner-says-hes-leaving-football-program/article_c50020bc-3ff9-11eb-b3d1-e3e1d6b48eca.html
3	Boobie Curry	WR	2019-20		1 stats	55.4 (2019 receiving)	“Projected to have a breakout season,” 16 rec/157 yds in two years; entered portal Dec 2020	https://wildcat.arizona.edu/121815/sports/starting-quarterback-grant-gunnell-wide-receiver-boobie-curry-enter-transfer-portal/

(all after Sumlin’s Dec 2020 firing, so attribution to Aych is weak):

UTEP, 2021 (inside WRs)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Jacob Cowing	WR	2021		5 1st team	90.3 (2021 receiving)	First-team All-C-USA; 69-1,354-7 (whether he was in Aych’s inside group: unverified)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jacob_Cowing
2	Justin Garrett	WR (JUCO, Los Angeles)	2021		3 HM/3rd	73.2 (2021 receiving)	50-685; HM All-C-USA 2019-20 (pre-Aych)	https://utepminers.com/sports/football/roster/justin-garrett/9764
3	Tyrin Smith	WR	2021		1 stats	68.0 (2021 receiving)	33-570	https://www.sports-reference.com/cfb/schools/texas-el-paso/2021-roster.html

LOW:

not found

Cowing transferred to Arizona Jan 2022, but Aych had already left for TSU (https://www.ktsm.com/sports/college-sports/utep/former-utep-wide-receiver-jacob-cowing-commits-to-arizona/). Not a true LOW.

Tennessee State, 2022-23 (OC) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Draylen Ellis	QB	2022-23		1 stats		2022 preseason All-OVC (earned pre-Aych); 2022: 153-279, 1,807 yds, 8 TD in 10 starts	https://tsutigers.com/sports/football/roster/draylen-ellis/4786
2	Devon Starling	RB	2022		1 stats		540 rush yds, 207 vs Eastern Washington; OVC Co-Freshman of Year 2021 (pre-Aych)	https://hbcugameday.com/2022/09/04/tennessee-state-displays-potent-offense-in-loss-to-no-12-eastern-washington/

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	Devon Starling	RB	2022		1 stats		Transferred to Northern Arizona Dec 2022 after a down year (540 yds)	https://www.thebluebloodscfb.com/former-tennessee-state-rb-devon-starling-transfers-to-northern-arizona/

2022 All-OVC and 2023 All-BS-OVC lists: not found.

Oklahoma State, 2025 (WRs)

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No returning letterwinners; room rebuilt via portal (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/oklahoma-state-wide-receivers-good-200004912.html). Season stats/honors not found; entire staff replaced when Eric Morris was hired Nov 25, 2025 (https://news.okstate.edu/articles/communications/2025/morris_named_osus_25th_football_coach).

UTRGV, 2026 (QBs) — in progress

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

QB Garret Rangel transferred from Oklahoma State citing his spring with Aych (https://www.krgv.com/news/how-new-utrgv-qb-garret-rangel-is-fitting-in-with-the-vaqueros/).

Archetype read

- Best outputs are physically oversized or athletically unusual converts: Walker (WR-to-NFL TE), Poindexter (6-5 late bloomer), Joiner (QB-to-WR), Washington (dual-threat QB with 831 rush yds).
- Low-pedigree origins dominate: walk-on (Berryhill), JUCO (Garrett), D2 recruits (Washington, Walker). No blue-chip HS recruit appears among TOPs.
- Production spikes in year 2-3 in the system rather than year 1 (Poindexter 2018, Washington 2014-15, Joiner 2019).
- Texas/Southwest footprint: Angelo State, UTEP x2, Houston, now UTRGV; Arizona WRs were largely Arizona/California.
- LOWs break the pattern mainly via staff churn (Sumlin firing, Starling leaving a struggling 4-7 offense), not talent misreads; Curry is the one “expected breakout” who did not produce.

Confidence: Timeline Medium (stops are consistent across OSU/Arizona/UTEP/UTRGV bios, but Central Missouri/Washington years conflict and 2008-10 is a hole; Houston title conflicts). Players Low-Medium (Washington, Poindexter, Cowing, Walker are well sourced; 2022-23 TSU and 2025 OSU honors, Angelo State non-QB honors not found).

Gaps: 2008-10 employment; head coaches at Mesabi Range/Fort Scott/Houston/Washington/Central Missouri/Marshall/UTEP 2021 not confirmed; 2022 All-OVC, 2023 All-BS-OVC, 2015 All-LSC, 2025 OSU receiving stats; 2026 UTRGV QB stats/honors. No evidence of any Texas HS head-coaching stint.

Adrian McDonald — Pass Game Coordinator / Safeties Coach

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
2012-15	Houston	Player, S (Eisenhower HS, Lawton OK); 49 games, 42 straight starts	HC Tony Levine (2012-14), Tom Herman (2015); DB/safeties coach Zac Spavital (through 2014), Craig Naivar co-DC/safeties (2015); DC David Gibbs (2013-14)	https://uhcougars.com/sports/football/roster/adrian-mcdonald/1000 ; https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/zac-spavital/2054 ; https://uhcougars.com/news/2015/1/5/Herman_Names_Four_to_Houston_Coaching_Staff
2016-17	San Diego Chargers / Buffalo Bills	UDFA DB, ~two seasons	—	https://www.chargers.com/photos/photos-former-db-adrian-mcdonald ; https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/adrian-mcdonald/1213
2018	Sam Rayburn HS (Pasadena, TX)	DBs coach + special-education teacher	HC not found	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/adrian-mcdonald/4354
2019-20	Texas State	Defensive GA (M.Ed. 2021)	HC Jake Spavital; DC Zac Spavital (his Houston position coach)	https://txst.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/adrian-mcdonald/1213 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Jake_Spavital
2021-22	Midwestern State (D2, LSC)	DBs / special teams / recruiting coordinator; also “coordinated passing game and coverages”	HC Bill Maskill; DC Rich Renner	https://msumustangs.com/news/2021/2/1/football-former-local-standout-to-coach-defensive-backs-at-midwestern-state.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_Midwestern_State_Mustangs_football_team
2023-	UTRGV	Pass game coordinator / safeties / recruiting coordinator (RC title dropped by 2026); hired March 6 per bio, release dated March 10	HC Travis Bush; AHC/DC Brian Gamble	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/adrian-mcdonald/731 ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2023/3/10/football-hires-adrian-mcdonald-as-first-defensive-backs-coach.aspx

Tree / mentors

- Zac Spavital: coached him at Houston (turnover-driven secondaries; McDonald led AAC with 6 INT in 2013) and brought him to Texas State as GA — the central tree relationship.
- Tony Levine / David Gibbs (Houston 2013-14), Tom Herman / Craig Naivar (2015): Gibbs-style aggressive, takeaway-focused 4-2-5.
- Jake Spavital (Texas State HC 2019-22).
- Bill Maskill / Rich Renner (MSU, 4-3 base per Wikipedia).
- Travis Bush / Brian Gamble (UTRGV): 2025 defense led Southland in five statistical categories (https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/brian-gamble/730).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Houston, 2012-15 (as player, for context)

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

17 career INT (school record), 299 tackles, 7 FF, 7 FR; All-AAC first team 2013; two-time All-AAC; Jim Thorpe semifinalist (https://uhcougars.com/sports/football/roster/adrian-mcdonald/1000 ; https://thedailycougar.com/2015/09/18/senior-safety-key-playmaker-defense/).

Sam Rayburn HS, 2018 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No player data found.

Texas State, 2019-20 (defensive GA) — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No position-group attribution; no players documented.

Midwestern State, 2021-22 (DBs) — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Malik Sonnier	S (Sr.)	2021		1 stats		All-LSC defensive honors; 2021 team 7-3, LSC champion	https://msumustangs.com/news/2021/11/18/football-sterling-cole-march-lead-midwestern-state-contingent-on-all-lone-star-conference-teams.aspx
2	Dylon Davis	CB (Fr.)	2021				All-LSC defensive honors as a freshman	not found

LOW:

not found

2022 All-LSC DBs: not found.

UTRGV, 2023-present (safeties; 2025 first varsity season, 9-3, 5-3 SLC, 7-0 home)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Alijah Prosser	S/nickel (“star”), Fr.	2025		6 AA/POY		FCS Football Central Freshman All-American; 52-yd pick-six vs Texas Wesleyan; key returner 2026	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/adrian-mcdonald/4354 ; https://ditvsports.com/2026-spring-football-guide/
2	Elijah Graham	DB, Sr. (#8)	2025		6 AA/POY		Phil Steele FCS Midseason All-American; declared for NFL draft	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/adrian-mcdonald/4354 ; https://rgvsports.com/utrgv-vaqueros-set-to-kick-off-spring-ball-monday/
3	Logic Hudgens	DB	2025		3 HM/3rd		Phil Steele All-Southland 4th team	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/logic-hudgens/12599

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
4	TJ Neal	position unverified	2025				Southland Defensive Player of the Week	https://www.krgv.com/news/utrgv-s-tj-neal-named-southland-conference-defensive-player-of-the-week

LOW:

not found

Archetype read

- Ball-production profile mirrors McDonald himself: interception/turnover makers (Prosser pick-six; Graham All-American buzz; McDonald's 17 INT) rather than box-safety types.
- Youth and early impact: Davis (Fr. All-LSC), Prosser (Fr. All-American) — he gets first-year players on the field.
- Versatile nickel/"star" usage (Prosser) consistent with the pass-game-coordinator title and Spavital/Gibbs-style coverage emphasis.
- Regional Texas/Oklahoma pipeline likely (Houston, Pasadena, San Marcos, Wichita Falls, RGV), but hometowns/ratings of the listed players were not retrievable — unverified.
- No LOW performers surfaced, so no pattern-break can be stated.

Confidence: Timeline High (UTRGV, Texas State, MSU and Houston bios agree on every stop and year; only the March 6 vs March 10, 2023 hire date differs). Players Low (only 2021 MSU and 2025 UTRGV honors found; 2022 MSU and official 2025 All-Southland DB names, player sizes/ratings/hometowns not reached).

Gaps: Sam Rayburn HC and 2018 roster; 2022 LSC honors; full 2025 All-Southland DB list; any 2025-26 UTRGV DB portal departures; recruiting ratings/sizes for all listed players; Houston 2012 DC name.

Gunnar Henderson — Pass Game Coordinator / Wide Receivers

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
2018–19	Incarnate Word (FCS)	Player, WR (also DB as a freshman); 10 games 2018, 12 games 2019 (8 rec, 95 yds); 2018 Southland co-champions; later team captain	HC Eric Morris (hired Jan 2018 from Texas Tech OC)	https://rgvsports.com/?p=211719 ; https://myrgv.com/?p=162257 ; https://www.uiw.edu/news/2018/2018cardinalsfootballcoach.html
2020	Texas A&M	Walk-on WR; released with all walk-ons due to COVID-19, never on roster	HC Jimbo Fisher (unverified)	https://myrgv.com/?p=148641
2021–22	TCU	Walk-on WR/special teams 2021; scholarship March 2022; 13 rec, 235 yds, 2 TD in 26 games; played in CFP title game Jan 2023; graduated 2023	HC Gary Patterson (2021), HC Sonny Dykes (2022) (unverified by snippet)	https://gofrogs.com/sports/football/roster/gunnar-henderson/14361 ; https://rgvsports.com/?p=225821 ; https://myrgv.com/?p=144830
2023	New Orleans Saints	Rookie minicamp invite; did not make team	—	https://rgvsports.com/?p=224862
Fall 2024	UTRGV	Graduate student coach, wide receivers	HC Travis Bush; WR coach Chris Brasfield (hired Jan 2024)	https://rgvsports.com/?p=203913 ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2024/1/11/football-hires-chris-brasfield-as-wide-receivers-coach.aspx
June 2025–2025	UTRGV	Wide Receivers Coach (promoted)	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/6/25/football-promotes-gunnar-henderson-to-wide-receivers-coach.aspx
2026–	UTRGV	Pass Game Coordinator / Wide Receivers	HC Travis Bush; co-OC/QB Theron Aych	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/coaches/2026 ; https://www.footballscoop.com/2026/01/15/sources-emerging-fcs-power-lands-big-12-assistant

Tree / mentors

- Travis Bush (UTRGV HC, 2023–): only coaching mentor; Bush promoted him from GA to full-time in one year.
- Chris Brasfield (UTRGV WR coach 2024): the WR coach Henderson apprenticed under; whether Brasfield left is not found.
- As a player: Eric Morris (UIW, Air Raid lineage), Sonny Dykes (TCU, Air Raid lineage) — scheme link inferred, unverified.
- Essentially a two-season coach (one as GA). Player section is short by design.

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

UTRGV wide receivers, 2025 (GA in 2024 — no attributable production)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Tony Diaz	WR (true Fr)	2025		6 AA/POY		1st Team All-Southland; Southland Freshman of the Year; AP FCS All-America Honorable Mention; FCS Football Central, Stats Perform and Phil Steele Freshman All-American; 68 rec / 875 yds / 11 TD (KRGV) vs 67 / 881 / 11 (SI) — sources differ; entered portal Dec 2025, committed to Iowa Jan 9, 2026 (Baylor also offered)	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/11/25/football-marburger-diaz-earn-major-southland-awards.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/17/football-diaz-named-ap-all-american-honorable-mention.aspx ; https://www.krgv.com/news/former-utrgv-star-receiver-tony-diaz-transfers-to-iowa ; https://www.si.com/college/baylor/football/baylor-offers-the-southland-freshman-of-the-year-in-the-transfer-portal-tony-diaz
2	Xavyion (Xayvion) Noland	WR	2025		4 2nd team/FOY		2nd Team All-Southland (per Oregon State roster bio; confirm on Southland release); 831 yds / 7 TD; 2 rec 126 yds 2 TD in opener; committed to Oregon State Jan 2026	https://osubeavers.com/sports/football/roster/xavyion-noland/12217 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UT_Rio_Grande_Valley_Vaqueros_football_team ; https://www.krgv.com/news/former-utrgv-star-receiver-tony-diaz-transfers-to-iowa

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	none documented	—	—		1 stats		No source documents a UTRGV WR who was highly rated and failed to produce. The opposite problem: Diaz, Noland and TE Smith Flores (24 of 33 passing TDs) all left for FBS after one season; a converted North Texas safety, Jaydon Smith, was added via portal	https://www.krgv.com/news/former-utrgv-star-receiver-tony-diaz-transfers-to-iowa

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Archetype read

- Sample is one season, two receivers; treat as provisional. Both top producers were young (Diaz a true freshman) and produced at a level that got them FBS/P4 offers within a year — the room functions as a development-and-export pipeline rather than a retention one.
- High-volume, high-TD usage: Diaz 11 TD, Noland 7 TD alongside QB Marburger's 31 passing TD in a 39.6 ppg offense; the scheme feeds receivers rather than tight ends.
- Noland's opener (2 catches, 126 yds, 2 TD) suggests a vertical/explosive role; Diaz's 68 catches suggests a volume/possession role. Size, recruiting ratings and HS/JUCO origin for both: not found.
- No LOW performers break the pattern because none are documented.

Confidence: Timeline High (consistent across UTRGV releases, local papers and the TCU roster). Players Medium-Low (honors are well sourced, but it is one season; Noland's 2nd-team honor rests on an Oregon State bio).

Gaps: Diaz and Noland recruiting ratings/hometowns/sizes; full 2025 UTRGV receiving leaderboard; whether Brasfield remains on staff; 2026 in-season WR production under Henderson as PGC.

Mike Barela — Run Game Coordinator / Tight Ends

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
(years not found)	North Texas	Player, LB / special teams	not found	https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/20
1996–98	North Texas	Graduate assistant, OL/TE	HC not confirmed (Matt Simon 1994–97, Darrell Dickey from 1998; unverified)	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/733
1999	Morningside (NAIA)	OL coach; coordinated strength & conditioning	HC not found	https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/20
2000–01	Sam Houston State	Tight ends coach	HC Ron Randleman	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/733
2002–06	North Texas	Director of Football Operations	HC Darrell Dickey	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/733 ; https://meangreensports.com/news/2006/2/7/Dickey_Announces_Football_Staff_Changes
2007–10	Texas State	Tight ends coach / Director of Football Operations; 2008 Southland title	HC Brad Wright; assoc. HC/co-OC Travis Bush (2007–09)	https://txst.com/news/2009/9/2/090209aaa_175 ; https://vstateblazers.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/2025 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/mike-barela/784
2011	Southwest Baptist (D2)	OL coach	HC not found	https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/20
2012–13	Northeastern State (D2, MIAA)	OL coach / run game coordinator / recruiting coordinator; 2013 AFCA D2 Assistant Coach of the Year finalist	HC Kenny Evans	https://goriverhawksgo.com/news/2013/11/28/FB_1128134528.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kenny_Evans_(American_football
2014	Kansas high school (school not found)	not found	not found	https://vstateblazers.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/2025
2015–17	Incarnate Word (FCS)	TE coach (2015, 2017), nickelbacks (2016), run game coordinator	HC Larry Kennan (fired Nov 2017 after 1-10)	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/733
2018–21	Colorado Mesa (D2, RMAC)	TE 2018–19; OL 2020; added co-OC 2021	HC Russ Martin (2018–19; no-huddle spread using TEs/H-backs); HC Tremaine Jackson (2020–21)	https://cmumavericks.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/2314 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Russ_Martin_(American_football
2022–23	Valdosta State (D2, GSC)	OL coach / travel coordinator (followed Jackson from CMU)	HC Tremaine Jackson	https://vstateblazers.com/news/2022/2/1/football-jackson-fills-out-coaching-staff-for-2022.aspx ; https://vstateblazers.com/staff-directory/mike-barela/380
Jan 2024–	UTRGV	Tight ends coach; added Run Game Coordinator for 2026	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/news/2024/1/12/football-hires-mike-barela-as-tight-ends-coach.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/4232

Tree / mentors

- Travis Bush — worked together at Texas State 2007–09 (Bush assoc. HC/co-OC); Bush hired him at UTRGV.
- Tremaine Jackson (CMU 2020–21, VSU 2022–23) — moved Barela from TE to OL and co-OC; VSU 2022 offense 36 ppg, 5th in D2 total offense (475.6 ypg), 2nd nationally in sacks allowed (3 in 367 attempts) (https://vstateblazers.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/2025).
- Russ Martin (CMU 2018–19) — no-huddle spread with heavy TE/H-back use.

- Larry Kennan (UIW), Kenny Evans (NSU), Brad Wright (Texas State), Darrell Dickey (UNT, ops role), Ron Randleman (SHSU). Barela's own clinic material: "Using your Tight End in Zone Blocking" (https://coachtube.com/course/football/using-your-tight-end-in-zone-blocking/11489249) — zone-run, blocking-TE orientation.

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Northeastern State OL / run game, 2012–13

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Michael Bowie	OT	2012	NFL	6 AA/POY		All-MIAA 2nd Team; D2Football.com All-America HM; no sacks allowed, 47 knockdowns; drafted 7th rd (No. 242) 2013 by Seattle; Super Bowl XLVIII; Oklahoma State transfer	https://goriverhawksgo.com/news/2013/4/27/FB_0427131225.aspx ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Michael_Bowie
2	unnamed	RB/OL	2012		1 stats		Line with five new starters produced a 1,000-yd rusher and two all-conference OL (names not found)	https://goriverhawksgo.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/51

LOW:

not found

none documented (team went 4-6, 2-9).

Incarnate Word TE / run game, 2015–17

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Cole Wick	TE	2015	NFL	5 1st team		1st Team All-Southland; 30 rec, 364 yds, 2 TD; UDFA Detroit Lions 2016 (6 NFL games), later 49ers/Titans/Saints PS	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2015_Incarnate_Word_Cardinals_football_team ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cole_Wick
2	TE group	TE	2017		1 stats		36 catches, 321 yds, 7 TD combined (no individual All-Southland TE in 2016–17)	https://uiwcardinals.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/mike-barela/733

LOW:

not found

Colorado Mesa TE (2018–19) / OL (2020–21)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Caelan Keenan	C	2021		3 HM/3rd		All-RMAC 2nd Team; D2CCA All-Region 2nd Team; team 8-2	https://cmumavericks.com/sports/football/roster/caelan-keenan/16831

LOW:

not found

TE honors 2018–19: not found. LOW: none documented.

Valdosta State OL, 2022–23

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Devin Hannan	OL	2023		6 AA/POY		AFCA All-America 1st Team; AP D2 All-America 2nd Team; D2CCA All-Region 2nd; Gene Upshaw nominee; started every game, VSU 12-2, shared GSC title	https://gscsports.org/news/2023/12/12/gsc-football-trio-named-ap-all-americans.aspx

LOW:

not found

2022: no OL on All-GSC (https://vstateblazers.com/news/2022/11/17/football-four-blazers-named-to-all-gulf-south-conference-teams.aspx). LOW: none documented.

UTRGV tight ends, 2025 (program's first season)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Ismael Smith Flores	TE (RS-So, 6-5)	2025		1 stats		9 starts, 20 rec / 244 yds / 6 TD (7th SLC in rec TD); former 3-star Nebraska signee (Arlington Martin) who played defense at Nebraska; transferred to East Carolina Jan 2026	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/mike-barela/784 ; https://www.krgv.com/news/former-utrgv-tight-end-ismael-smith-flores-announces-commitment-to-east-carolina/ ; https://ecupirates.com/sports/football/roster/ismael-flores/14300

LOW:

not found

none documented (Jaxson Shupe, RS-Fr TE, 3 games, no receiving stats — depth note only). No UTRGV TE made the 2025 All-Southland teams.

Archetype read

- The two biggest hits (Bowie, Smith Flores) were Power-5 drop-down transfers with a position change or fresh start; Barela's best outcomes come from reclamation/conversion projects rather than blue-chip HS recruits.
- Tight ends under Barela are blocking-first with modest catch totals but red-zone value: Wick 30 catches, Smith Flores 20 catches but 6 TD; his clinic material is zone-blocking TE play.
- Honors cluster on the offensive line when he coaches OL (Bowie, Keenan, Hannan) and on unit metrics (sacks allowed, total offense) rather than individual TE awards.
- Texas footprint: Smith Flores (Arlington), UIW/Texas State/SHSU/UNT stops; Bowie (Tulsa) is the exception.
- No documented LOW performers; the only "departure" pattern is talent leaving upward (Smith Flores to ECU).

Confidence: Timeline Medium-High (three school bios agree on stops; disagreements on UTRGV hire year 2023 vs 2024 and Valdosta end 2023 vs 2024). Players Medium (named honorees are well sourced; CMU 2018–19 TE, 2012 NSU all-conference OL, UIW 2017 TE names and Texas State 2007–10 TE honors beyond John Gilley's 2008 HM, https://txst.com/news/2008/11/26/112608aag_904, were not found).

Gaps: HC names for UNT GA years, Morningside, Southwest Baptist, 2014 Kansas HS; full All-RMAC 2020–21 and All-GSC 2022–23 OL lists; UTRGV 2026 rushing results under his run-game title; recruiting ratings/sizes for Wick, Keenan, Hannan.

Marco Regalado — Running Backs (also Recruiting Coordinator)

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
–2014	Texas State	Student; B.S. exercise & sport science 2014 (Zapata, Texas native)	—	https://riceowls.com/sports/football/roster/staff/marco-regalado/112 ; https://footballscoop.com/sources-texas-university-to-add-rice-staffer
2014–16	Texas A&M-Kingsville (D2)	Graduate assistant, defensive line; M.S. educational administration 2016	HC Daren Wilkinson (2015–19; 2016 team 9-3); 2014 HC not found	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/marco-regalado/4229 ; https://footballscoop.com/news/daren-wilkinson-will-not-return-at-texas-am-kingsville/
2017–19	not found	gap in every bio snippet	—	not found
2020	V.R. Eaton HS (Haslet/Fort Worth, UIL 6A)	RB coach / recruiting coordinator; "best season in school history"; reached 6A playoffs	HC not found	https://riceowls.com/sports/football/roster/staff/marco-regalado/112 ; https://eaglenationonline.com/24388/sports/analysis-eagle-football-ends-season-ranked-no-26-in-texas/
2021	Washington State	Recruiting assistant → director of on-campus recruiting → director of recruiting	HC Nick Rolovich / Jake Dickert (unverified)	https://on3.com/news/marco-regalado-rice-washington-state
June 2022–Nov 2023	Rice	Executive Director of Player Personnel & Recruiting Innovation; NFL liaison; 247Sports 30 Under 30 (2021), FootballScoop Minority Watch List (2022)	HC Mike Bloomgren	https://riceowls.com/sports/football/roster/staff/marco-regalado/112 ; https://www.afca.com/inside-the-headset-marco-regalado-exec-dir-of-player-personnel-recruiting-innovation-rice/
2023 (summer)	Jacksonville Jaguars	Bill Walsh Diversity Coaching Fellowship (TE/special teams group)	HC Doug Pederson (unverified)	https://www.jaguars.com/news/jaguars-add-eight-coaches-via-the-bill-walsh-diversity-coaching-fellowship ; https://rgvsports.com/zapata-native-regalado-helps-shape-utrgv-football/
Nov 27, 2023–	UTRGV	Running Backs Coach / Recruiting Coordinator; AFCA 35 Under 35 honoree	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/news/2023/11/27/football-hires-marco-regalado-as-assistant-coach.aspx ; https://www.afca.com/35-under-35-presents-marco-regalado-utrgv-vertical-mentality-in-the-rb-room/

Tree / mentors

- Travis Bush (UTRGV) — hired him for recruiting ties to South Texas; Regalado built UTRGV's first two recruiting classes.
- Mike Bloomgren (Rice) — personnel/recruiting mentor; Regalado's Rice subordinate Peter Chung became youngest DPP in CFB (https://news.rice.edu/news/2023/rice-alum-now-youngest-director-player-personnel-college-football).
- Daren Wilkinson (TAMUK) — only on-field coaching mentor before UTRGV; DL GA, not a RB role.
- Philosophy on record: "vertical mentality" / downhill running (AFCA 35 Under 35; https://www.utrgvrider.com/?p=46863).
- Note: before UTRGV his on-field RB coaching was one HS season; most of his career was personnel/recruiting. Player section is correspondingly short.

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Texas A&M-Kingsville DL (GA), 2014–16 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No DL honorees found; GA role, not attributable. LOW: none.

V.R. Eaton HS RB, 2020 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

Team made 6A playoffs; no individual RB honors or signees found. LOW: none.

Rice personnel, 2022–23 — not a position coach; class rankings not found.

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

UTRGV running backs, 2025

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Nathan Denney	RB (grad transfer from Yale)	2025		4 2nd team/FOY		884 rush yds, 4.68 ypc, 73.8 ypg (2nd SLC, 36th FCS); Phil Steele 2nd Team All-Southland; SLC Offensive Player of the Week Sept 8; departed after season (graduate)	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/nathan-denney/12585 ; https://www.southland.org/news/2025/9/8/utrgvs-denney-lamars-pugh-and-woodard-earn-southland-football-players-of-the-week.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/11/24/football-denney-earns-slc-offensive-player-of-the-week-honorable-mention.aspx
2	TJ Dement	RB (Fr)	2025		1 stats		5 rushing TD as a freshman; returning starter candidate 2026	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/marco-regalado/780 ; https://www.krgv.com/news/utrgv-running-backs-group-looking-strong-ahead-of-2026-season/
3	Djouvensky Schlenbaker	RB (RS-Jr)	2025		1 stats		Scored first rushing TD in program history (Aug 30 vs Sul Ross); season stats not found	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UT_Rio_Grande_Valley_Vaqueros_football_team

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
4	Fabian Garcia, Brennan Carroll	RB	2025		1 stats		Rotation backs; Garcia returning 2026; no honors found	https://www.smdailyjournal.com/sports/marburger-utrgv-dominate-naia-member-texas-wesleyan-in-61-13-win/article_23aef303-1aeb-5438-a60c-5a325ed4a84b.html

LOW:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	What happened	Source
1	none documented	—	—		1 stats		No source reports a UTRGV RB losing a job, transferring out for lack of production, or being dismissed. 2026 adds LSU transfer Malachi Lane	https://www.krgv.com/news/utrgv-running-backs-group-looking-strong-ahead-of-2026-season/

Archetype read

- One season of RB data; the lead back was an Ivy League graduate transfer (Denney, Yale) — a mature, pass-catching, high-floor back in a committee rather than a blue-chip HS recruit.
- Production is committee-based and TD-distributed (Denney 884 yds, Dement 5 TD, Schlenbaker, Garcia, Carroll all used; QB Marburger added 4 rush TD) inside a pass-first 39.6 ppg offense.
- Stated philosophy favors downhill/vertical runners; Denney's 4.68 ypc behind a first-year line matches that profile.
- Transfer-heavy sourcing continues (Denney from Yale, Lane from LSU for 2026), consistent with Regalado's personnel-department background.
- No LOW performers to contrast; pattern is unproven beyond 2025.

Confidence: Timeline Medium (Rice, UTRGV, Jaguars and WSU stops are well sourced; TAMUK 2014 HC, the 2017–19 gap, and the Eaton HS head coach are not found). Players Low-Medium (Denney's honors are solid; other backs' season stats and any recruiting ratings not found; pre-UTRGV stops have no attributable players).

Gaps: 2017–19 employment; Eaton HS 2020 HC and record; TAMUK 2014 HC and any DL honorees 2014–16; Rice 2022/2023 class rankings; full 2025 UTRGV rushing leaderboard; Denney's post-UTRGV destination; 2026 in-season RB results.

James Lockhart IV — Outside Linebackers Coach

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
HS (to 2014)	Ennis HS (Ennis, TX)	DE/LB; as a junior 122 tkl, 8 sacks, 3 FF, All-State HM	n/a	https://baylorbears.com/sports/football/roster/james-lockhart/9310 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/james-lockhart-iv/788
2015–16	Texas A&M	Player, DL (16 games); 2016 SEC All-Academic	HC Kevin Sumlin (unverified)	https://baylorbears.com/sports/football/roster/james-lockhart/9310 ; https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/staff/james-lockhart/291
Jan 2017–2019	Baylor	Player, DE (redshirt 2017; 43 career games, 16 starts); 2019 All-Big 12 HM (31 tkl, 8.5 TFL, 6.0 sacks)	Position coach Joey McGuire (Assoc. HC/OLB); HC Matt Rhule 2017-19 (unverified)	https://baylorbears.com/sports/football/roster/james-lockhart/9310 ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2024/1/25/football-hires-james-lockhart-iv-as-outside-linebackers-coach.aspx
2020	Pittsburgh Steelers / SF 49ers	UDFA signee; waived Aug 2020; claimed by 49ers, chose to retire	n/a	https://triblive.com/sports/steelers-round-out-undrafted-free-agent-class-by-signing-baylor-de-james-lockhart/ ; https://www.cbssports.com/nfl/players/3159161/james-lockhart/
2020–21 or 2021 only (sources disagree)	Baylor	Defensive graduate assistant; M.S. Sport Pedagogy 2021	HC Dave Aranda; DC Ron Roberts; OLB Caleb Collins / Assoc. HC Joey McGuire	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/james-lockhart-iv/788 ; https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/staff/james-lockhart/291 ; https://baylorbears.com/sports/football/coaches/2021
2022–23	Texas Tech	Defensive quality control assistant, worked directly with OLBs	HC Joey McGuire; DC Tim DeRuyter; OLB coach C.J. Ah You	https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/staff/james-lockhart/291 ; https://texastech.com/news/2022/2/23/c-j-ah-you-joins-texas-tech-staff-as-olb-coach.aspx
Jan 25, 2024–present	UTRGV	Outside linebackers coach	HC Travis Bush; DC Brian Gamble	https://goutrgv.com/news/2024/1/25/football-hires-james-lockhart-iv-as-outside-linebackers-coach.aspx

Tree / mentors

- Joey McGuire (Baylor DE/OLB coach 2017-21, Texas Tech HC 2022-23): the defining relationship; McGuire officiated Lockhart's 2023 wedding (https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/staff/james-lockhart/291). Texas Tech under DeRuyter ran a 3-4/odd front built on edge rushers (https://www.texasfootball.com/amp/article/2022/08/17/the-lone-star-50-no-10-tyree-wilson-poised-for-big-sack-numbers-in-new-look-texas-tech-defense).
- C.J. Ah You (Texas Tech OLB coach): Lockhart's direct supervisor as QC; described by Texas Tech as a developer of "edge-type rushers" (https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/c-j-ah-you/3770).
- Dave Aranda / Ron Roberts (Baylor 2020-21 GA years); Brian Gamble (UTRGV DC, 4-2-5 base per https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_UT_Rio_Grande_Valley_Vaqueros_football_team; preseason coverage calls it a "3-4 hybrid" https://rgvsports.com/utrgv-football-kicks-off-fall-camp-thursday/).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Texas Tech, 2022–23 (QC only; players belong to Ah You/DeRuyter)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Tyree Wilson	Edge/DE	2022	NFL	5 1st team	75.1 (2022 defense)	1st-team All-Big 12 (13.5 TFL, 7.0 sacks); No. 7 overall pick, 2023 NFL Draft (Raiders)	https://texastech.com/sports/football/roster/tyree-wilson/10326

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
2	Jesiah Pierre	OLB (2022) / ILB (2023)	2022-23		3 HM/3rd	60.1 (2022 defense)	7.0 TFL, 4.5 sacks at OLB in 2022; HM All-Big 12 at LB 2023	https://ucfknights.com/sports/football/roster/player/jesiah-pierre

LOW:

not found

UTRGV, 2024–present (2024 was a no-games prep year; first season 2025)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Jaiden Haygood	LB	2025		6 AA/POY		Phil Steele Freshman All-American 1st team; FCS Football Central Freshman AA; 2026 Phil Steele preseason All-SLC 1st team (unit assignment ILB vs OLB unverified)	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/29/football-places-five-on-phil-steele-freshman-all-american-teams.aspx
2	Ian Box	DE/edge, 6-3 236, R-Jr., Seguin TX, Lamar transfer	2025		1 stats		All-Southland 2nd team (Phil Steele 2nd team); 8.0 TFL, 5.5 sacks (5 vs. HCU); UTRGV bio credits Lockhart with his development	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/ian-box/12113 ; https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/james-lockhart-iv/788 ; https://www.krgv.com/news/first-utrgv-football-transfer-de-ian-box-to-face-his-former-team/
3	Percy Jackson III	Edge	2025		1 stats		24 tkl, 6.5 TFL, 2 sacks, 2 FF, 1 FR (no all-conference honor found)	https://rgvsports.com/utrgv-football-kicks-off-fall-camp-thursday/

LOW:

not found

not found. Unit note: UTRGV credits Box to Lockhart's OLB room while the roster lists him DE and Langford's bio claims the DL; treat Box/Jackson/Anderson as a shared edge pool. Unit stats: 2025 UTRGV 5th in SLC in TFL/game (6.5), 4th in sacks/game (2.25) (https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/james-lockhart-iv/788).

Archetype read

- The two documented producers (Box; Wilson by association) are long, 235-265 lb edge rushers used as stand-up/hand-down hybrids in odd-front looks, not true off-ball LBs.
- Box is an in-state Texas product (Seguin, same town as Bush/Langford's HS stop) who arrived as an FCS-to-FCS transfer with an injury-shortened prior season, i.e., a bounce-back profile rather than a high-rated recruit.
- Lockhart's own profile (Ennis TX, 6-2/263, P5 transfer DE) mirrors the type: Texas HS, DE frame, relentless-effort tag.
- Sample is one season of his own coaching; no LOW cases documented, so no pattern break to report.

Confidence: Timeline High (multiple school bios agree; only the GA start year is disputed). Players Low (one coaching season, unit assignments blurred between OLB and DL rooms, no official 2025 All-SLC team list retrieved).

Gaps: Full 2025 All-Southland team list; which UTRGV LBs are formally in the OLB room; HC/DC names at A&M and Baylor during his playing years; no transfer-out/LOW data.

Nate (Nathan) Langford — Defensive Line Coach

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
HS	San Marcos HS (TX)	Player	n/a	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/nate-langford/4228
2004–07	Texas State	Player, DE; 2005 starting DE on 11-3 FCS semifinal team; All-Southland + team captain as senior (one UTRGV snippet instead says "2006 All-SLC 2nd team DE as a junior" — sources disagree); B.S. 2009	HC David Bailiff / Brad Wright; Travis Bush on staff as WR coach 2004-06, co-OC 2007	https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/nate-langford/778 ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/nate-langford/4228 ; https://txst.com/news/2007/7/25/072507aac_995
years not found	San Marcos HS	Assistant coach	not found	https://www.texasfootball.com/article/2021/04/26/this-week-in-txhsfb-bridgeport-luling-merkel-nocona-and-comanche-make-hires
2016–20 (UTRGV bio says 2015-20 in one place)	Seguin HS	Assistant HC / defensive coordinator	HC Travis Bush	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/nate-langford/4228 ; https://seguintoday.com/2021/03/03/bush-formally-approved-as-new-braunfels-canyon-football-coach-reflects-on-time-in-seguin/
2020	Concordia (TX)	M.Ed. Coaching & Sports Administration	n/a	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/nate-langford/4228
Apr 19, 2021–Nov 2023	Luling HS	Head coach / athletic director (first HC job)	n/a	https://texashsfootball.com/exclusive-new-coach-interview-nate-langford-looks-to-turn-the-tide-at-luling/ ; https://www.statesman.com/story/sports/2021/04/21/high-school-football-anderson-steps-down-football-coach-elgin/7323112002/
Nov 15, 2023–present	UTRGV	Hired as "assistant coach"; listed Defensive Line Coach 2025 and 2026	HC Travis Bush; DC Brian Gamble	https://myrgv.com/rgvsports/2023/11/15/utrgv-football-adds-nathan-langford-as-assistant-coach/ ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/coaches/2026

Tree / mentors

- Travis Bush is the whole tree: Langford played at Texas State while Bush coached there (2004-07), then was Bush's DC at Seguin, then was hired by Bush at UTRGV. Seguin results under Bush/Langford: 2018 district title and first playoff berth in 12 years; shared district titles 2018-20; Langford's 2018 defense rated DCTF "6th Most Improved Defense in the state" (https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/nate-langford/4228).
- Brian Gamble (UTRGV DC): 4-2-5 base / 3-4 hybrid.
- Scheme as a HS coordinator: not documented.

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Seguin HS DC, 2016–20 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No individual all-district or signee data found. Team-level only (see tree). LOW: not found.

Luling HS HC, 2021–23 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

Records: 2021 2-7 (MaxPreps: 2-8), 2022 6-5, 2023 2-7; 2021 was the program's first playoff trip in eight years after three winless seasons, and DCTF rated his defense "8th Most Improved Defense by a First-Year Head Coach" (https://www.texasfootball.com/team/luling-eagles ; https://www.maxpreps.com/tx/luling/luling-eagles/football/history/). No individual honorees found. LOW: not found.

UTRGV DL, 2024–present (first games 2025)

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Ja'Marcus Anderson	DL (R-So./So., class listing disputed)	2025		6 AA/POY		Phil Steele FCS Freshman All-American 2nd team; All-Southland 3rd team; 29 tkl, 4.5 TFL, 2 sacks, 5 QBH, 1 FF in 11 games/2 starts	https://goutrgv.com/news/2025/12/29/football-places-five-on-phil-steele-freshman-all-american-teams.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/ja-marcus-anderson/12898
2	Ian Box	DE, 6-3 236, Seguin TX, Lamar transfer	2025		1 stats		All-Southland 2nd team; 8.0 TFL, 5.5 sacks (also credited to Lockhart; see above)	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/ian-box/12113 ; https://www.southland.org/news/2025/11/25/southland-announces-2025-all-conference-football-team-and-superlatives.aspx
3	Nathan Huerta	NT, grad transfer from Texas State	2025		1 stats		11 starts at nose; returns 2026	https://rgvsports.com/utrgv-d-line-looks-to-set-tone-for-vaqueros-in-year-2/
4	Percy Jackson III	Edge/DL	2025		1 stats		24 tkl, 6.5 TFL, 2 sacks, 2 FF	https://rgvsports.com/utrgv-football-kicks-off-fall-camp-thursday/

LOW:

not found

Unit stats: 2025 UTRGV 3rd in SLC in points allowed (18.8), 4th in sacks/game (2.25); entire DL returns for 2026 (https://goutrgv.com/staff-directory/nate-langford/778 ; https://www.texasfootball.com/article/2026/08/11/utrgv-2026-preview).

not found. (Nicholas Fernandez, an Arizona DL transfer in the 2025 class, and DE David Nwabuoku were on the 2025 roster, but no source documents either as a disappointment: https://www.utrgvrider.com/utrgv-vaqueros-add-38-on-national-signing-day/.)

Archetype read

- Both honorees are Texas-rooted and arrived through non-blue-chip paths: Box an FCS (Lamar) transfer with an injury-shortened prior year, Anderson a developmental redshirt who produced as a rotational sub (2 starts) rather than a full-time starter.
- Undersized-for-position edge frames (Box 236 lb at DE) with production concentrated in TFL/sacks rather than run-stuffing; the nose (Huerta) is a veteran grad transfer from Bush's old program, Texas State.
- Pattern of "fix-the-defense" credentials at every HS stop (DCTF most-improved tags 2018, 2021) suggests Langford's value is development of overlooked players rather than recruiting rated ones.
- No LOW performers documented, so no counter-pattern available.

Confidence: Timeline Medium (UTRGV bios and news agree on the sequence but disagree on Seguin start year and on his All-Southland year/team; San Marcos HS years not sourced). Players Low (one college season; HS stops have no individual data).

Gaps: 2006 All-SLC team list; San Marcos HS assistant years; any Seguin/Luling all-district or college signees; UTRGV transfer-out data for DL.

Josh Jones — Special Teams Coordinator / Cornerbacks Coach

Timeline

Years	School	Role	Worked under (HC / coordinator)	Source
c. 2009–12	MSU Moorhead (D2), then Harding (D2)	Player, DB; MSU Moorhead school-record 10 INT as a sophomore; described as D2 All-American; B.A. Professional Studies, Arkansas Tech 2013	not found	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/4374 ; https://www.footballscoop.com/2025/03/03/northwestern-state-brad-laird-adds-joey-fitzgerald-rashad-jackson-josh-jones-kevon-beckwith
c. 2013–14	Utah Blaze (AFL), Green Bay Blizzard (IFL)	Player, one season each	n/a	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/4374
2015 (Aug 2015–Apr 2016)	Henderson State (D2)	Cornerbacks	HC Scott Maxfield	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/4374 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Scott_Maxfield
2016–17	Central Arkansas	Cornerbacks	HC Steve Campbell; DC Greg Stewart	https://ucasports.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/649 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2017_Central_Arkansas_Bears_football_team
2018–20	South Alabama	Cornerbacks	HC Steve Campbell; DC Greg Stewart (4-3 base)	https://usajaguars.com/staff-directory/josh-jones/445 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2019_South_Alabama_Jaguars_football_team
2021 (spring SWAC season, “short stint”)	Arkansas-Pine Bluff	Safeties / defensive passing-game coordinator	HC not sourced	https://uapblionsroar.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/joshua-jones/503
2021–22	Northwestern State	Safeties (2022: + recruiting coordinator)	HC Brad Laird	https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/2021 ; https://nsudemons.com/sports/football/roster/2022
2023	The Citadel	Secondary (primarily safeties), NFL liaison, assisted special teams; recruited Dallas and San Antonio	HC Maurice Drayton	https://citadelsports.com/news/2023/3/16/football-josh-jones-defensive-backs ; https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/2/11/football-hires-josh-jones-as-cornerbacks-coach.aspx
2024–25	San Antonio Brahmas (UFL)	Defensive backs	HC Wade Phillips; DC Will Reed (2024). 2025 HC unresolved	https://theufl.com/news/brahmas-announce-2025-coaching-staff ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2025_San_Antonio_Brahmas_season
2025 (camp)	Green Bay Packers	Bill Walsh Diversity Coaching Fellowship	n/a	https://www.acmepackingcompany.com/2025/6/4/24443404/green-bay-packers-news-nick-collins-morgan-burnett-coaching-staff-update-2025
Feb 11, 2026–present	UTRGV	Hired as Cornerbacks; 2026 directory lists Special Teams Coordinator / Cornerbacks	HC Travis Bush; DC Brian Gamble	https://goutrgv.com/news/2026/2/11/football-hires-josh-jones-as-cornerbacks-coach.aspx ; https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/coaches/2026

Tree / mentors

- Steve Campbell / Greg Stewart (UCA 2016-17, South Alabama 2018-20): five straight seasons; 4-3 base at USA. UCA went 20-5, 17-1 SLC, 2017 outright Southland title (https://usajaguars.com/staff-directory/josh-jones/445 ; https://www.southland.org/news/2017/11/21/southland-announces-2017-all-conference-football-teams.aspx).
- Scott Maxfield (Henderson State): 2015 defense led all NCAA divisions with 29 INT (https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/4374).
- Wade Phillips / Will Reed (Brahmas): 2024 defense first in UFL in total defense, scoring defense, sacks and TDs allowed; 7-3, lost UFL title 0-25 (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2024_San_Antonio_Brahmas_season).
- Brad Laird (NSU), Maurice Drayton (Citadel, 0-11 in 2023).

Players by stop (ranked: NFL, then production, then PFF; highest to lowest)

Henderson State CBs, 2015 — thin

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Tavares Garner	DB	2015		5 1st team		1st-team All-GAC; team 11-2, D2 playoffs	https://goutrgv.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/4374

LOW:

not found

Central Arkansas CBs, 2016–17

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Tremon Smith	CB	2016-17 (at UCA 2014-17)	NFL	5 1st team		1st-team All-Southland 2015-17 (UCA page lists 2015-16); 37 career passes defensed (10 INT); 6th round, No. 196, 2018 NFL Draft (Chiefs); later Texans	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Tremon_Smith ; https://ucasports.com/sports/football/roster/tremon-smith/4950
2	Tyler Williams	CB, 6-1 194, Norcross GA, Hutchinson CC transfer	2016 (senior)		6 AA/POY		UTRGV/UCA bio: All-Southland and “multiple All-American teams after leading the nation in pass break-ups” — year/team not independently verified	https://ucasports.com/sports/football/roster/coaches/josh-jones/649 ; https://ucasports.com/sports/football/roster/tyler-williams/3504

LOW:

not found

South Alabama CBs, 2018–20

TOP:

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
1	Jalen Thompson	CB/flex	2018-20		3 HM/3rd	72.2 (2019 defense)	Program all-time INT leader (9); PFF 3rd-team All-Sun Belt (flex) 2019	https://usajaguars.com/staff-directory/josh-jones/445 ; https://www.pff.com/news/college-football-2019-pff-all-sun-belt-team
2	Darian Mills	CB	2018 (year unverified)		1 stats	70.1 (2018 defense)	All-Sun Belt; 2nd in conference in PBU	https://usajaguars.com/staff-directory/josh-jones/445

#	Player	Pos	Years	NFL	Production	PFF best	Honor / outcome	Source
3	Devin Rockette	CB	2019		1 stats	62.9 (2019 defense)	PFF All-Sun Belt HM; 6 PBU, 1 INT in first season as starter	https://www.pff.com/news/college-football-2019-pff-all-sun-belt-team ; https://usajaguars.com/staff-directory/josh-jones/445

LOW:

not found

not found (team went 3-9 in 2018 and 4-7 in 2020; staff turned over after 2020).

UAPB (spring 2021), Northwestern State safeties 2021–22, Citadel 2023 — thin

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

No safety honoree attributable to Jones found. Citadel 2023 went 0-11. LOW: not found.

San Antonio Brahmas DBs, 2024–25

TOP:

not found

LOW:

not found

(pro; honors not found): Darius Phillips, Bryce Thompson, Teez Tabor, Corey Mayfield among 2024 CB stat leaders; S Jordan Mosley 2nd in UFL in tackles (75) in 2024 (https://www.foxsports.com/ufl/san-antonio-brahmas-team-stats?category=defense&season=2024). No Brahmas DB found on an All-UFL team; 2025 team 1-9. LOW: not found.

Archetype read

- His best corners are ball-production players: Smith (10 INT/37 PD), Thompson (school-record 9 INT), Williams (nation-leading PBU claim), Henderson State's 29-INT defense; the common thread is takeaways/PBU volume over size.
- Origins skew JUCO/small-school and Southern (Williams from Hutchinson CC via Georgia; Smith an Alabama native at an FCS program); no P5-rated recruit appears on the list.
- All documented production came in a Campbell/Stewart 4-3 at FCS/G5 level; his safeties and pro stops yielded no documented honorees, so the archetype is "FCS/G5 cornerback who tackles and plays the ball," not a press-man specialist.
- No LOW cases documented; cannot identify where the pattern broke.

Confidence: Timeline High (six school bios plus UFL staff releases agree; only the 2025 Brahmas HC and the UAPB HC are unresolved). Players Medium for UCA/South Alabama (school bios plus PFF/NFL draft records), Low elsewhere.

Gaps: Tyler Williams' All-American year and team; Darian Mills' honor year; UAPB head coach; NSU/Citadel safety honorees under Jones; any 2024 All-UFL DB; transfer-out or benching cases at any stop; why UTRGV added the special-teams title after the Feb 2026 hire.
